MORE THAN HIV: PINOY STIGMA IN 2D ANIMATION

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In Partial Fulfillment of the Requirement for the Degree
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology
Specialized in Animation and Motion Graphics

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The Researchers

DEDICATION

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And most especially, to people living with HIV, this project is dedicated to them. May it serve as a voice to promote empathy, awareness, and acceptance, reminding everyone that no one should face silence or discrimination for their truth.

A.R.N.B.

J.P.O.M.

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L.A.V.T.

ABSTRACT

This capstone project focuses on the development of a 2D animated short film designed to depict and raise awareness about HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. The animation aims to deliver a meaningful and narrative that highlights the experiences of individuals facing HIV stigma, emphasizing compassion, understanding, and the importance of breaking misconceptions. The project supports global advocacy efforts aligned with Sustainable Development Goal 3 (Good Health and Well-Being), Sustainable Development Goal 5 (Gender Equality), and Sustainable Development Goal 10 (Reduced Inequalities) by promoting inclusive attitudes, combating discrimination, and advocating for equal treatment for people living with HIV. The animation was evaluated using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), assessing respondents' Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, Attitude Toward Using, and Behavioral Intention. A total of 30 college students of Laguna State Polytechnic University Los Banos Campus participated in the film-viewing and survey evaluation. Results showed high acceptance across all categories, indicating a positive audience response. Findings demonstrate that the animated film effectively increased understanding of HIV stigma and fostered supportive attitudes toward individuals living with HIV. Additionally, results affirm that 2D animation is a powerful medium for health education and social awareness campaigns.

Keywords: *HIV stigma, Animation, SDG 3, SDG 5, SDG 10, Awareness, Technology Acceptance Model*

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DEFINITION OF TERMS

2D Animation	A style of animation that creates movement in a flat, two-dimensional space.
Awareness	Knowledge and understanding about HIV, impact of stigma on individuals and society.
Discrimination	Unfair treatment of people based on HIV status, including exclusion, judgment, and denial of opportunities.
HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus)	A virus that attacks the body's immune system, making it harder to fight infections and diseases. If left untreated, it may lead to AIDS.
HIV Stigma	Negative attitudes, beliefs, and discrimination toward people living with HIV, often caused by misunderstanding, fear, or lack of proper information.
Narrative Animation	A storytelling approach using animated characters and scenes to deliver a message; in this project, it is used to illustrate real-life stigma experiences and promote empathy.
PLHIV (People Living With HIV)	Individuals who have been diagnosed with HIV, regardless of their stage of infection, treatment status, or physical health condition.
Sustainable Development Goal 3 (SDG 3)	A United Nations goal focused on ensuring healthy lives and promoting well-being for all, including reducing HIV-related health risks and improving access to treatment and education.
Sustainable Development Goal 5 (SDG 5)	A United Nations goal that promotes gender equality and aims to eliminate discrimination and violence, including stigma affecting women living with HIV.

Sustainable Development Goal 10 (SDG 10)	A United Nations goal focused on reducing inequality and discrimination, including combating HIV stigma and ensuring equal treatment regardless of health status.
Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)	A model used to measure how users accept and respond to technology, focusing on perceived usefulness, ease of use, attitude, and behavioral intention—in this case, the effectiveness of the 2D animation as an awareness tool.
Treatment (ART – Antiretroviral Therapy)	Medication used to help people living with HIV stay healthy by controlling the virus, allowing them to live long and productive lives.

CHAPTER I

INTRODUCTION

Project Context

According to the World Health Organization (2024), HIV remains a major global health issue, having claimed an estimated 42.3 million lives to date. Transmission continues in all countries worldwide. HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus) is a virus that attacks cells that help the body fight infection, making a person more vulnerable to other infections and diseases, it is spread by contact with certain bodily fluids of a person with HIV, most commonly during unprotected sex (sex without a condom or HIV medicine to prevent or treat HIV), or through sharing injection drug equipment (hiv.gov 2023).

The Philippines is currently facing the fastest-growing HIV epidemic in the Western Pacific region, with new HIV infections and AIDS-related deaths increasing by an alarming 418% and 535%, respectively, from 2010 to 2022. As of March 2024, the Department of Health (DOH) reported an average of 55 new HIV diagnoses per day. The agency also noted that among the 122,255 individuals living with HIV in the country, only 64%—or 78,633 people—are receiving antiretroviral therapy. According to projections, the estimated 189,000 people living with HIV (PLHIV) by the end of 2023 is expected to more than double, reaching approximately 401,700 by 2030 (Cordero Jr., Dalmacito A., National Library of Medicine).

Mrakovcic (2024) highlights that in the Philippines, societal perceptions of HIV significantly influence its transmission and treatment. Mrakovcic also stated that due to stigma and discrimination, the country is currently

experiencing the fastest-growing HIV epidemic in the Western Pacific. Furthermore, stigma and discrimination extend beyond healthcare. People living with HIV (PLHIV) in the Philippines faced many challenges in employment, education, and social inclusion (UNAIDS, 2023). A 2021 study published by the International Labour Organization (ILO) found out that workplace discrimination and forced disclosure of HIV status remain prevalent in the country, discouraging individuals from seeking employment or disclosing their condition.

The Philippine government has enacted the RA 11166 which is the Philippine HIV and AIDS Policy Act that strengthens HIV prevention programs and promotes equal rights and address the growing HIV crisis in the Philippines. The International organizations such as UNAIDS and WHO continue to advocate for awareness campaigns, expand the healthcare access, and anti-stigma initiatives to combat the HIV crisis epidemic effectively.

As HIV cases continue to rise in the Philippines, it is important to address the widespread misinformation and harmful stigmas surrounding the condition. This capstone project focuses on confronting these stigmas—particularly in Filipino communities—through a 2D animated video. By highlighting real-life inspired experiences and promoting accurate information, the project aims to bring attention to the social challenges faced by people living with HIV and emphasize the need for open, informed conversations about the issue.

Project Objectives

The primary goal of this project was to develop a 2D animated video addressing HIV-related stigma in the Filipino context. Specifically, the project aimed to:

1. Identify HIV-related stigma experienced by Filipinos, particularly through interview with individual living with HIV and from video documentaries;
2. Produce a two-dimensional animated video depicting Filipino HIV stigma;
3. Assess the video using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM).

Project Purpose

Sustainable Development Goal 3 (SDG 3) underscores the importance of ensuring healthy lives and promoting well-being for people of all ages. In line with this objective, the purpose of this project is to address HIV-related stigma in the Philippines, particularly the discrimination and social judgment that people living with HIV commonly experience. Through the creation of a 2D animated video, the project seeks to shed light on the everyday realities of stigma within Filipino society.

Beyond SDG 3, the project also contributes to other Sustainable Development Goals. It aligns with SDG 5: Gender Equality, recognizing that stigma disproportionately affects women and LGBTQ+ individuals. Additionally, it advances SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities by challenging the barriers and discrimination that limit the opportunities of people living with HIV. Finally, by promoting inclusion and respect for human rights, the project resonates with SDG 16: Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions, fostering a more just and compassionate society.

Community. By showing the HIV-related stigmas existing in Filipino society, this 2D animated video seeks to help the community. It exposes the

social stigma experienced by those people living with HIV. Through showing these stigmas, the film promotes understanding and introspection.

People living with HIV. Addressing the stigmas that people with HIV frequently encounter in Filipino communities, this capstone project seeks to assist those individuals. The project aims to foster empathy and understanding by drawing attention to these problems through a 2D animated film. By doing this, it helps to create a more secure and encouraging environment where people can seek treatment, testing, and emotional support without fear of social, educational, or medical discrimination.

Future Researchers and Developers. This project could serve as a useful reference for researchers and developers in the animation and healthcare domains in the future. It details how 2D animation can be used to address and depict the stigma associated with HIV in Filipino communities. Further research that examines the use of creative media to draw attention to social challenges and public health issues may build upon this work.

Scope and Limitation of the Study

This capstone project aims to create a 2D animated video that tackles HIV-related stigma in the Filipino context. It seeks to illustrate the prejudice, misunderstandings, and social judgments that people living with HIV (PLHIV) frequently encounter. The project aims to depict the stigma that still exists in Filipino society by concentrating on these genuine and frequently disregarded experiences.

The 2D animated video is narratively driven, featuring fictional stories that reflect real-life situations faced by individuals experiencing HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. It is designed to be emotionally impactful, using

culturally relevant language, visuals, and scenarios to portray challenges of those affected by stigma. The target audience includes Filipino communities, particularly adolescents and young adults, as well as families and educators—groups that play a key role in shaping perceptions and attitudes toward people living with HIV.

While the video is suitable for sharing on social media and in classroom settings, it does not aim to provide clinical or medical advice, nor cover all aspects of HIV/AIDS or every social stigma in Filipino society. The project's reach and long-term behavioral impact may also be influenced by external factors such as school policies, parental guidance, and broader societal attitudes.

CHAPTER II

THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK OF THE PROJECT

Review of Related Literature, Studies, and Systems

This chapter presents existing literature and previous studies relevant to research. It serves as a foundation to prevent redundancy and acknowledge the contributions of other researchers.

- Studies on 2D Animated
- Studies on HIV Transmission and Control
- Studies on HIV Stigma in the Philippines
- Studies on Forms of HIV Discrimination
- Studies on Psychological Impact of HIV Stigma
- Studies on Efforts to Reduce HIV Stigma

A literature review involves organizing and comparing scholarly works on a specific topic, structured around a central theme such as a research objective, thesis, or key issue. It entails the interpretation and synthesis of source materials in a structured manner, progressing from broad concepts to more specific discussions while addressing both theoretical and methodological aspects. The primary purpose of a literature review is to present original analyses or experimental findings and make them accessible to the academic community.

2D Animated

The detailed development of animation, from the first hand-drawn approaches to the advanced computer-generated imagery (CGI) and stop-motion techniques used in modern times, is a fascinating story. The essay highlights how adaptable animation is as a medium, highlighting its ability to

produce both two dimensional and three-dimensional sequences, catering to diverse artistic visions and storytelling needs. By exploring the transition from traditional practices to modern digital technologies, Srikanth underscores the enduring relevance of animation in shaping visual narratives across various media platforms (Srikanth, V. 2023). Commemorates a significant milestone in animation history—the twentieth anniversary of Hayao Miyazaki's masterpiece, "Spirited Away." Produced by Studio Ghibli, this Japanese animated film not only captivated audiences worldwide but also challenged conventional notions of animation as a genre primarily geared towards children. Moon reflects on the film's enduring legacy, highlighting its transcultural appeal and profound impact on the global animation landscape. Through its rich narrative tapestry interwoven with Japanese folklore, "Spirited Away" stands as a testament to the universal language of storytelling through animation (Moon, K. 2021).

The transformative influence of digital media technology on the landscape of animated television productions. With the advent of cutting-edge computer technologies and information communication systems, animation has undergone a paradigm shift, enabling creators to craft increasingly immersive and visually stunning narratives. Through a nuanced exploration of digital media's integration into animation workflows, Liu elucidates the myriad ways in which technology has enriched the storytelling capabilities of animators, ushering in a new era of creative expression and innovation (Liu, G. 2020).

Conducts a nuanced analysis of Disney's portrayal of princesses across its extensive animated filmography, spanning from the classic era to contemporary productions. By examining themes of race, class, and gender representation, Tyner Mullings elucidates the evolving dynamics within Disney's

princess narratives, revealing both recurring patterns and noteworthy deviations. Through meticulous research and critical inquiry, the article provides valuable insights into the cultural significance of Disney's princess mythology, offering a foundation for further scholarly exploration into the complexities of animated storytelling (Tyner-Mullings, A. R. 2023).

The evolution of animation techniques, particularly the transition from traditional 2D to 3D animation and the emergence of hybrid approaches combining both methods. While 2D animation offers classic aesthetic and simpler line work, it requires meticulous frame-by frame synchronization. Conversely, 3D animation provides flexibility but entails higher production costs and smaller team sizes. The authors discuss the challenges faced by hybrid animation, such as style matching, registration issues, and technical considerations like frame rate and timing (Luntraru, C., Asavei, V., Moldoveanu, A., & Moldoveanu, F. 2022). Explore the efficacy of incorporating 2D animation into undergraduate business management education. Their study reveals that 2D animation positively influences student learning outcomes, particularly when compared to traditional PowerPoint presentations. Through thematic analysis and participant observations, they underscore the advantages of using animated characters and emphasize the enhanced role of lecturers, especially in online teaching environments. The research highlights the potential of innovative teaching methods like 2D animation in fostering student engagement and preparing them for leadership roles in knowledge-driven economy (Qinran, Y. and Cao, W. 2021).

HIV Transmission and Control

Between 2012 and 2023, daily HIV case numbers rose by 411%. A significant issue remains the late detection of the virus, as 29% of newly diagnosed cases in January 2023 already showed signs of advanced HIV disease. The epidemic has had a particularly strong impact on men who have sex with men (MSM). In response, the country has implemented several measures to combat the spread of HIV. One key step was the enactment of the Philippine HIV and AIDS Policy Act of 2018 (Republic Act 11166), which broadened access to testing and treatment services. The law also permits minors aged 15 to 17 to undergo HIV testing without needing parental consent. The number of treatment hubs and primary HIV care centers is steadily growing. However, significant challenges to eradicating the HIV epidemic still exist. These include persistent stigma, a lack of comprehensive harm reduction services for people who inject drugs, as well as sociocultural and political obstacles.

In 2023, an average of 41 individuals were diagnosed with HIV each day, with gay, bisexual, and other men who have sex with men (GBM) making up the majority of people living with HIV (PLHIV) (Department of Health-Epidemiology Bureau, 2024). While HIV is increasingly seen as a manageable health condition (World Health Organization, 2022), this group remains at elevated risk for additional health issues such as hypertension, chronic kidney disease, and substance abuse (Paudel et al., 2022). Additionally, mental health concerns compound the experiences of both HIV (Pereira et al., 2022; Too et al., 2021) and gender-related stigma (Brener et al., 2023).

Based on the evidence, we argue that the intersecting stressors highlight how the experience of living with HIV is deeply intertwined with broader issues like homophobia, patriarchal cultural values, and religious fundamentalism factors that continue to drive this silent epidemic. Specifically, the widespread stigma stemming from multiple sources and systems is evident in the lives of Filipino GBM living with HIV, whose experiences are influenced by socio-structural forces and cultural dynamics.

Among Southeast Asian (SEA) countries, the Philippines was found to have the most accepting attitudes toward gay men and lesbians (Manalastas et al., 2017). Nevertheless, negative perceptions of the LGBTQ+ community persist among Filipinos (Abesamis & Alibudbud, 2024). Recent surveys indicate that queer individuals across the SEA region—including those in the Philippines—still face unfavorable attitudes (Bilon & Clemente, 2024). These biases are also mirrored in the national policies of SEA countries, which often fall short in protecting LGBTQ+ rights.

Culturally, LGBTQIA+ individuals in the Philippines face stigma largely rooted in religious beliefs (Ruiz Austria, 2004). With religion playing a significant role in the lives of many Filipinos, this strong religiosity often contributes to negative perceptions of GBM (United States Agency for International Development [UNAIDS] & United Nations Development Program [UNDP], 2014). Since HIV is closely linked to sex and sexuality, Filipino GBM are frequently viewed as sinful within the cultural context (Canoy & Ofreneo, 2012). This belief is heavily shaped by the moral teachings of the Roman Catholic Church (Ruiz Austria, 2004). As Canoy and Ofreneo (2017) observed, Filipino GBM living with HIV who are in same-sex relationships often feel compelled to

question their identities, as they navigate the conflict between their sexuality, their HIV status, and the religious framing of sin. In a society deeply influenced by conservative religious values, stigma can be deeply ingrained. This intersection of HIV-related and queer stigma is often linked to notions of “morality, dirtiness, and sin” (Adia et al., 2018, p. 322).

Forms of HIV Discrimination

HIV discrimination manifests in healthcare settings, workplaces, and educational institutions. In the healthcare sector, some patients with HIV report denial of treatment, breach of confidentiality, and judgmental attitudes from healthcare providers (WHO, 2023). Workplace discrimination also remains a problem, with employees losing jobs or facing workplace harassment after their HIV status is disclosed (ILO, 2022).

Psychological Impact of HIV Stigma

HIV stigma also leads to internalized stigma, where individuals develop shame, guilt, and fear of disclosure, resulting in mental health issues like anxiety and depression (Logie & Gadalla, 2020). Fear of discrimination discourages HIV testing and adherence to antiretroviral therapy (ART), increasing the risk of disease progression (Pulerwitz et al., 2021).

Efforts to Reduce HIV Stigma

Global organizations such as UNAIDS, WHO, and local government agencies have implemented awareness campaigns, policies, and laws to combat HIV stigma and discrimination. The Philippine HIV and AIDS Policy Act (RA 11166) was enacted to strengthen HIV prevention programs and ensure the rights of people living with HIV (PLHIV) (DOH, 2023). Community-based initiatives and peer support programs have also been found effective in

reducing stigma and improving health-seeking behaviors (Mabachi et al., 2022).

Addressing HIV stigma and discrimination in the Philippines requires comprehensive education, policy enforcement, and healthcare reforms. By promoting awareness, inclusion, and accessible healthcare, the stigma surrounding HIV can be reduced, encouraging more individuals to seek testing, treatment, and support.

Synthesis and Relevance of the Study

Reviewed literature and studies emphasize the growing relevance of HIV awareness and the potential of 2D animation as an educational medium. The global and local data highlight the alarming increase in HIV cases, particularly in the Philippines, where cultural and societal norms significantly shape public perception. Cultural values like *hiya* (shame) and *pakikisama* (conformity) aggravate HIV-related stigma, leading to discrimination in healthcare, education, and workplaces. Psychological impacts such as depression and anxiety are prevalent among PLHIV due to internalized stigma and social exclusion.

On the other hand, animation as a communication tool has evolved from traditional techniques to advanced digital storytelling. Studies show that 2D animation is not only visually engaging but also effective in delivering complex ideas with emotional depth. By using culturally relatable narratives, it becomes a powerful medium to educate communities, correct misconceptions, and foster empathy. This capstone project integrates these perspectives, aiming to produce a short 2D animated video that realistically portrays Filipino HIV

stigma. The project serves both as an awareness tool and as a model for future digital interventions in public health education.

Literature Matrix

Table 1. Literature Matrix

Author(s)	Title	Method/Algorithm	Key findings	Year
Cordero Jr., A.	HIV Epidemic in the Philippines: A National Overview	Reinforces the urgency of addressing HIV stigma and misinformation through engaging media.	The Philippines has one of the fastest-growing HIV epidemics in Asia, with low ART coverage.	2025
World Health Organization	HIV and AIDS	Establishes the need for awareness campaigns like this project to reduce stigma and misinformation.	HIV continues to be a global health threat, with stigma as a barrier to testing and treatment.	2024
Mrakovcic, J.	Stigma and the HIV Epidemic in Southeast Asia	Supports the cultural lens used in the animation to reflect real Filipino experiences.	Cultural beliefs and moral judgment contribute to HIV-related stigma in the Philippines.	2024
UNAIDS	Global AIDS Update	Justifies the use of animation to educate and break stigma in a relatable and engaging way.	Discrimination and lack of education about HIV are key reasons people avoid testing and treatment.	2023
Tyner-Mullings, A. R.	Gender and Representation in Animation	Emphasizes the importance of representing PLHIV respectfully and accurately in the animation.	Animation can challenge stereotypes and shape audience perception through character design and storytelling.	2023

Eustaquio et al.	Filipino Values and HIV Stigma	Reinforces the need to culturally tailor the animation to Filipino societal norms.	Values like *hiya* (shame) and *pakikisama* (conformity) influence stigma in local communities.	2021
Logie & Gadalla	Meta-Analysis on HIV Stigma and Mental Health	Informs the emotional tone and character experiences within the animation.	HIV stigma causes depression, anxiety, and isolation among PLHIV.	2020
Mabachi et al.	Community-Based Strategies to Reduce HIV Stigma	Supports the project's use of animated storytelling as a stigma-reduction strategy.	Peer education and multimedia campaigns reduce stigma effectively.	2022
Luntraru et al.	2D vs. 3D Animation: Visual Storytelling Techniques	Validates the choice of 2D animation as a medium for delivering HIV awareness content.	2D animation is effective for emotionally resonant and culturally specific educational messages.	2022
Qinran & Cao	2D Animation in Educational Settings	Backs up the educational impact of using animation for sensitive topics like HIV stigma.	Animated content boosts retention and engagement compared to traditional methods.	2021
Pulerwitz et al.	Measuring HIV Stigma and Its Impact	Aligns with the project's goal to encourage testing and acceptance through awareness and empathy.	Stigma is linked to decreased HIV testing and treatment adherence.	2021
Liu, G.	Digital Media's Influence on Modern Animation	Supports the use of digital software in producing educational animations for public health issues.	Digital tools have transformed animation into a powerful educational medium.	2020

Conceptual Framework

The figure below presents the conceptual framework that guided the development of the proposed 2D animated video addressing HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. The process begins with identifying HIV-related stigma often experienced by Filipinos through interviews with individuals living with HIV and video documentaries online. This is followed by the conceptualization phase, which includes scriptwriting and planning for the 2D animated video that addresses the HIV stigma. The project's last phase focuses on the desired results of tackling stigma associated with HIV in the Philippines. Among these results is the promotion of more stigma-free and inclusive attitudes and behaviors in the community, especially among parents and young people. The capstone project seeks to establish a social setting where individuals feel valued and supported by drawing attention to the realities of stigma. The proposed 2D animated video project is planned and carried out according to this framework, to make sure that it accurately reflects and addresses these objectives.

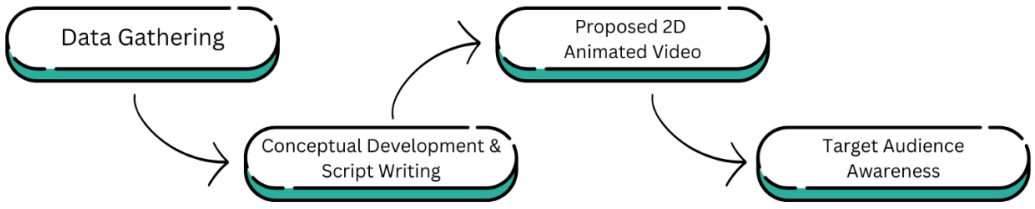


Figure 1. Conceptual Framework

CHAPTER III

METHODOLOGY

Project Design

This capstone project aims to address the stigma associated with HIV in the Filipino community, which continues to be a major obstacle to social inclusion, treatment, and testing. The project's goal is to illustrate the negative impacts of stigma and the social obstacles that people living with HIV (PLHIV) face by making a 2D animated short film. Stories based on actual events that represent the most prevalent HIV stigmas in the Philippines are included in the animation. The primary goal is to illustrate these stigmas and promote contemplation regarding their influence on Filipino society.

Animation Development Model

To effectively depict the most prevalent HIV-related stigmas in the Philippines, this 2D animated video is developed using a structured animation pipeline. Every stage of the procedure helped to produce an impactful and accurate portrayal that appeals to the audience.



Figure 2. Animation Development Model

Data Collection

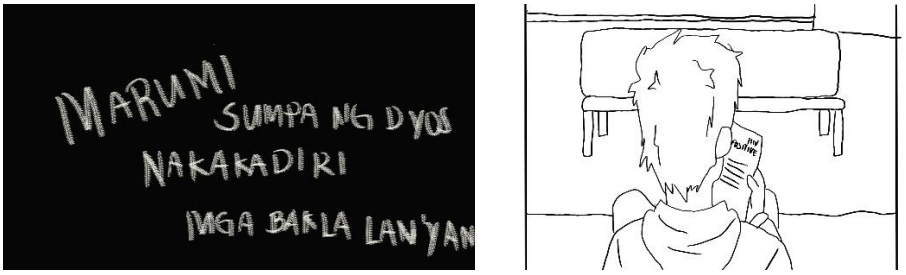
To guarantee the content's correctness and applicability, this first step is essential. Interviews with individuals living with HIV and video documentaries online are the sources of data that the researchers use. In this stage, the team makes sure that the goal of the study is well-defined and that the data collected from interviews and video documentaries online are meticulously checked for authenticity and correctness.

Script Conceptualization

The script serves as the foundation of the animation, outlining the actions, dialogue, and emotional flow of each scene. It is a story structure that guides the overall narrative. The script is developed based on the data collected from interview and online video documentaries from YouTube about HIV stigma in the Philippines, ensuring that the narrative is grounded in real experiences and authentic insights. At the same time, character designs are developed. Since the story is character-driven, the characters are visually and behaviorally reflecting their personality, background, and life experiences. The design process ensures that the characters resonate with the Filipino audience and realistically portray the stigmas being addressed.

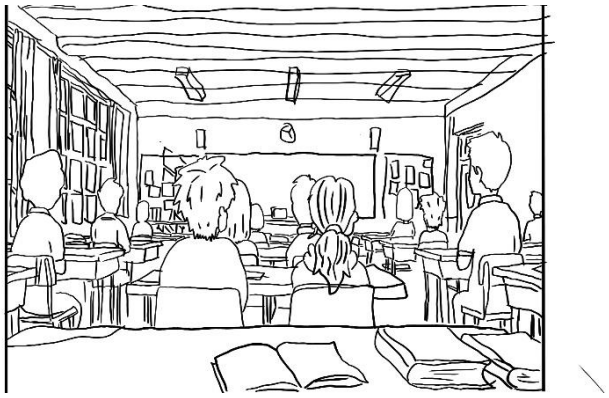
Storyboard

The storyboard serves as the visual blueprint of the entire video. It maps out scene compositions, camera angles, character positions and movements, key transitions and emotion beats. This step helps to visualize how each scene unfolds and ensure consistent tone pacing.



Opening Scene

The film begins in total darkness. Words like *“Marumi,” “Kasalanan nila,” “Mga bakla lang ‘yan,” and “Sumpa ng Diyos”* appear, stretched and warped like cruel specters closing in. These hateful words grow larger, tightening around the frame, visually symbolizing stigma turning into psychological pressure. Then collapses inward, swallowing itself into silence. Cut to Mark holding an HIV test result — breath shaky. His fear and confusion mirror the suffocating voices we just witnessed.



Scene 1

A college classroom buzzing with life. Students laugh and talk casually, unaware of Mark’s emotional burden. Mark sits quietly, trying to blend in. Two classmates, their whispers cut sharply through the friendly atmosphere — cruel assumptions about him losing his scholarship, and accusations about promiscuity. Mark sits at his desk, bowing his head to his desk as he hears whispers symbolizes internalized shame and social withdrawal.



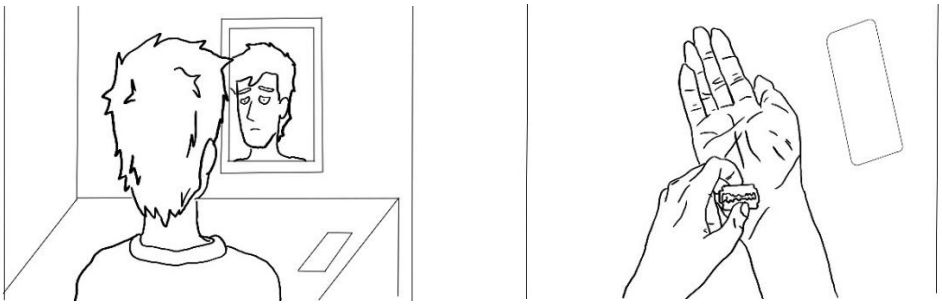
Scene 2

Inside a warm, noisy kitchen, plates clatter and conversations overlap — until Mark stands before his manager. The manager avoids eye contact, voice low, apologetic yet firm as he tells Mark the contract must end “because others don’t understand his condition.” Mark freezes. His hands grip: disbelief washes over him. This scene symbolizes rejection in workplace.



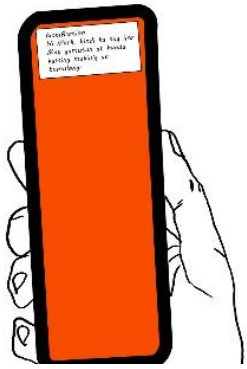
Scene 3

A typical Philippine barangay street — sari-sari store, neighbors chatting. But warmth quickly turns cold as Mark approaches. A cluster of neighbors whisper loudly enough for him to hear, spitting hateful assumptions tied to sexuality and religion. Mark walks faster. Faces around him covered in black— visual embodiments of judgment. The background fades black as hostility overwhelms him, and the world seems to close in.



Scene 4

In a dim bedroom, Mark sits alone in front of a mirror. The room is still, suffocating. His reflection gazes back, weary and defeated. Mark hears words in his mind like *“Marumi,” “Walang halaga,” “Mamamatay ka na”* symbolizes self-stigma and internalized discrimination. Mark whispers, broken, believing the words: *“Kasalanan ko… wala na akong kinabukasan.”* His trembling hands hint at a dangerous decision — a moment of despair where stigma becomes self-harm.



Scene 5

Just when darkness feels final, a notification sound breaks the silence. Mark’s phone lights up. A message from an HIV support group appears: *“Hindi ka nag-iisa. May gamutan. At handa kaming makinig at tumulong.”* The tone shifts — gentle, warm music begins. Mark pauses, absorbing the message. The suffocating tension loosens.



Scene 6

Mark enters a modest room nervously — a support group space filled with people from different walks of life: a student, a mother, an LGBTQ+ youth, an elderly man. Someone greets him smiling— a simple yet powerful welcome. As they talk and laugh together, Mark's posture softens, eyes brightening. This time the whispers fade into silence behind him. Strength replaces shame.

"Magkaisa tayo laban sa stigma."
"Suporta, hindi diskriminasyon."

Final Scene

The animation fades to a clean white background — peaceful and pure. Text slowly appears on screen: **"**Magkaisa tayo laban sa stigma. Supporta, hindi diskriminasyon.**"** Soft music ends with a hopeful note. Hotline or support group contact info gently fades in below, grounding the message in real-world help. The film ends not with silence — but with quiet strength.

Voice Recording

After storyboarding, the script is recorded as a voiceover, bringing the characters to life and providing narration and dialogue. The recorded audio is

synced with the storyboard frames to create an animatic rough cut animation to evaluate timing, pacing, and flow.

Sound Production

Sound design enhanced the emotional tone and realism of the animation. This includes background music, sound effects, (eg.g, ambient noise, movement sounds), and mixing and syncing of all audio elements for smooth playback. The background music and sound effects utilized in the project were obtained from YouTube, free for public use without copyright restrictions.

Animation

In this phase, the final 2D animation is created using Adobe After Effects. The Puppet Tool utilizes to animate character actions, emotions, and transitions in alignment with the storyboard and voiceover. Additionally, background elements such as cars and clouds are animated using Transform Position to create smooth movement and add depth and realism to the scenes.

Publication

Before publishing, all animation-related tasks were finished to ensure that any mistakes were found and corrected. Color grading was usually the last step in the production process. Although compositors and lighters aimed for visual coherence, they often focused only on specific scenes or segments. The color grader maintained the overall appearance and visual tone of the entire video, ensuring consistency throughout the sequences and preventing sudden changes in lighting or appearance.

Materials

Software Specification

The software specification outlines the tools and applications utilized in the development of this project. The primary software includes Adobe Photoshop CC 2023 for character design, background design and visual composition after that Adobe After Effects CC 2023 is used for animation, motion graphics and visual effects, and Audacity for editing and enhancing voiceover, sound effects and background music.

Adobe After Effects CC 2023

Served as the primary software for producing the final animation. Professional video editors and animators can achieve their visual goals using this program, which offers a comprehensive and reliable editing environment. The project utilizes various tools and features within Adobe After Effects—such as keyframing, puppet animation, transform controls, and visual effects—to bring the characters, scenes, and backgrounds to life, ensuring smooth movement and engaging visual storytelling.

Adobe Photoshop CC 2023

Adobe Photoshop CC 2023 served as the primary tool for character design, background creation, and storyboard development. Widely regarded as the industry standard for visual processing, Photoshop provides a comprehensive and flexible toolkit to meet a wide range of creative needs. This software is used to design animation characters, backgrounds, and visual effects, ensuring consistency and artistic quality across all visual elements. With its extensive filters and adjustment tools for precise color correction, image manipulation, and artistic effects, Photoshop enabled the project team to refine

character details, enhance physical features, and add realistic textures to the scenes and backgrounds.

Audacity

Audacity served as the software used for voice recording and audio editing of the project. Audacity is a free and open-source audio editing program known for its versatility and reliability. Audacity is used to record and edit the voices of the characters in the 2D animated video, with voice acting performed according to the script and synchronized with the animation to ensure a smooth and cohesive flow. Additionally, Audacity is used to edit and mix non-copyrighted music and sound effects—such as footsteps, car engine, heavy rain and water sounds—to add realism, depth, and emotional resonance to the overall sound design of the video.

Hardware Specifications

The following table are the hardware specifications used to create the 2D animated short films. Table 2 shows that the animation can achieve the task that is needed to finish this project, on a minimal requirement of just RAM of 8GB, SSD of 238GB, and low-end processor.

Table 2. Hardware specification.

Hardware	Specification
Processor	Intel(R) Core(TM) i3-813OU CPU 2.10GHz
RAM	8.00 GB
Graphics Processing Unit	Intel UHD Graphics Card
SSD	238 GB
Pen Tablet	XP-PEN Artist 10 Drawing Display (2nd Gen)

Research Design

The research methodology for this study was a purposive design. It aimed to describe the acceptance and impact of the developed 2D animation addressing HIV related stigma in the Philippines. The animation was created focusing on giving empathy to people living with HIV. The characters were designed to represent realistic Filipino experiences and emotions, shaping relatable personas that effectively convey the message of empathy and understanding. Through visual storytelling, the animation sought to influence viewers' perceptions, promote compassion toward people living with HIV.

Sampling technique

The table 3 shows that participants for this study were selected from the target demographic of college students in LSPU Los Baños, using a purposive sampling technique. This sampling method allows for the intentional selection of individuals who possess characteristics relevant to the study's objectives. College students were chosen as respondents because they are at a developmental stage where awareness of social and health issues—such as HIV and the stigma surrounding it—is critical. Their level of maturity and understanding enables them to provide meaningful feedback on the 2D animated video, particularly regarding its effectiveness in educating, raising awareness, and reducing stigma related to HIV in the Philippine context. A total of 30 college students participated in the study.

Table 3. Respondents of the study

Respondents	Number of Respondents
College Students	30
Total	30

Population of the study

The population of this study consists of college students who can understand and evaluate social and health-related issues, particularly those concerning HIV awareness and stigma. These participants were chosen because they represent a group that can critically reflect on societal attitudes and behaviors toward people living with HIV. Insights from this population are valuable in assessing the effectiveness of the 2D animated video in promoting accurate information, empathy, and stigma reduction.

Data Collection Instrument

A closed-ended questionnaire was utilized as the primary data collection instrument for this study. The questionnaire was designed to assess the audience's awareness, perception, and attitudes toward HIV and HIV-related stigma after viewing the 2D animated short film *"More Than HIV."* Respondents completed the questionnaire within approximately 15 to 20 minutes after viewing the short film. The collected responses were then analyzed and interpreted to determine the effectiveness of the animated video in promoting empathy and reducing misconceptions about HIV within the target audience.

Table 4. Likert Scale

Rating	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
5	Strongly agree
4	Agree
3	Neutral
2	Disagree
1	Strongly Disagree

A standardized questionnaire was adopted for the purpose, which assessed the efficacy of the 2D animated short film "More Than HIV" based on key criteria: Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, Attitude Towards Using, and Behavioral Intention, using the Technology Acceptance Model. These criteria have been used to evaluate a variety of ways in which the respondents perceive the said animation regarding its educational value, clarity of message, and overall impact it creates on the respondents' awareness and understanding of HIV-related stigma.

Data

Data for this study were obtained through several video documentaries regarding HIV stigma in the Philippines and through interview among PLHIV. These provided valuable insights into real-life experiences of stigma, discrimination, and misunderstanding that people with HIV face. From the information collated, some of the common themes that emerged included educational stigma, workplace discrimination, community judgment, and self-stigma, on which the narrative of the short film was founded.

The data led the way in developing the characters and storyline of the 2D animated short "More Than HIV." Through the incorporation of actual experiences and observations from the documentaries and interviews, the animation hopes to bring a sensitive and realistic portrayal of people living with HIV. And this, in a way, can be an assurance that the film will be able to create awareness and authentically represent the emotional and social burdens posed by stigma on Filipino society.

Statistical Instrument of Data

Descriptive statistics were used in this study to summarize the data, calculating the Mean (M) and Standard Deviation (SD), which were recorded in an MS Excel spreadsheet. IBM SPSS software was then employed to interpret the overall results, allowing for a thorough analysis of the data. This approach helped identify key trends and ensured the findings were statistically reliable, validating the effectiveness of the 2D animated video in achieving its educational goals.

Technology Acceptance Model

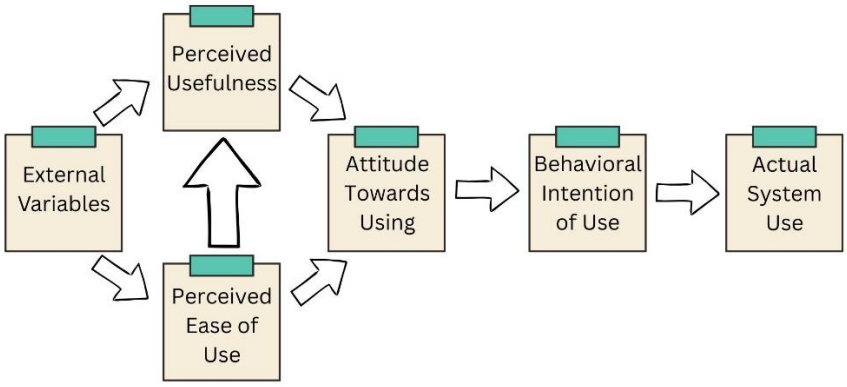


Figure 3. Technology Acceptance Model

The Technology Acceptance Model is an information systems theory that describes how individuals accept and use new technologies. It forms a useful basis for finding out why users may decide to use or not use a certain medium, including educational 2D animated films. While TAM does not involve data collection per se, it provides an effective theoretical model for analyzing how viewers respond to innovations in educational communication, such as animation for advocacy and awareness campaigns.

In the case of this research, TAM was applied to investigate the audience's acceptance of the 2D animated short film "More Than HIV." The

model centers on four important constructs: Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, Attitude Toward Using, and Behavioral Intention. These will determine whether the viewers found the animation educational, easy to understand, and engaging, especially in promulgating more awareness about HIV stigma in the Philippines. The principles of TAM can be used as the basis for acquiring relevant feedback to ensure that the short film is clear, relevant, and effective in encouraging empathy and reducing discrimination against people living with HIV.

Table 5 shows the reliability test results using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM). The internal consistency for all categories was highly reliable. In fact, all categories received ratings ranging from “Good” to “Excellent.” In other words, all the evaluation criteria were highly reliable to measure the perception and response of the audience. Moreover, the Composite Score .910 earned an “Excellent” rating, indicating that in general, the TAM model is highly reliable in this study.

This suggests that TAM is reliable and valid for testing the factors related to the audience's acceptance of the 2D animated short film "More Than HIV." The congruence across categories indicates that the instrument appropriately measured the perceived usefulness, clarity, and emotional impact of the animation by the viewers. Thus, TAM was an appropriate and valid tool in determining how the audience engaged and understood the digital animation of HIV stigma awareness.

Table 5. Reliability test result for Technology Acceptance Model

Categories	Cronbach Alpha's	Verbal Interpretation
Perceived of Usefulness	.962	Excellent
Perceived Ease of Use	.860	Good
Attitude Toward Using	.917	Excellent
Behavioral Intention	.900	Excellent
Composite Score	.910	Excellent

Legend: above .90 = Excellent, 0.80-0.89 = Good, 0.70-0.79 = Acceptable, 0.60-0.69 = Questionable, 0.50-0.59 = Poor, below 0.50 = Unacceptable

CHAPTER IV

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter presents the results of the study and analyzes the findings in the context of the main objective of the project, interpreting them using the principles and components of the Technology Acceptance Model.

Results by Objectives

Main Objectives

The main objective of this study is to develop a 2D animated video depicting HIV related stigma in the Philippines. This objective was achieved by thorough investigation, effort, as well as the equipment required to produce the video.

1. **Identified HIV-related stigma experienced by Filipinos.**

Character Creation: Based on insights gathered from interviews and video documentaries online about HIV stigma in the Philippines, it was found that misconceptions, discrimination, and self-stigma remain major barriers to understanding HIV. These findings guided the creation of the main character and supporting roles in the 2D animated short film *“More Than HIV.”*

There are four main character representations that embody different forms of stigma and awareness:

- Mark, a 22-year-old gay working college student, represents the youth who experience educational, workplace and community stigma due to their HIV status. His character was designed to reflect the real struggles of people living with HIV (PLHIV) — balancing self-worth, fear, and hope in a judgmental society.

- The Classmates represent *educational stigma*, showing how misinformation among students can create isolation and bullying.
- The Manager embody *workplace stigma*, highlighting discrimination that occurs when people misunderstand HIV transmission.
- The Neighbors personify *community stigma*, showing how gossip and moral judgment worsen the emotional burden of PLHIV.
- Finally, The Support Group Members serve as symbols of hope, acceptance, and education — individuals from different walks of life who remind Mark (and the audience) that living with HIV does not define one's value as a person.

The creation of these characters aims to mirror real societal attitudes while promoting empathy and understanding. Each character was carefully developed to reflect a stage in Mark's emotional and social journey — from fear and rejection to acceptance and empowerment.

Story: The story is based on interview and video documentaries online about HIV stigma in the Philippines. Experts say stigma often occurs because of lack of education, moral prejudice, and cultural silence around sexuality and health-some of the biggest themes in the film.

The story of "More Than HIV" is an emotional journey of Mark, who experiences denial in school, at work, and in the community, until he experiences self-stigma. Through a message of support and eventually getting connected with an HIV support group, however, the story changes to one of hope, comprehension, and self-acceptance. The storytelling approach of this educational, yet emotional, video helps viewers to reflect upon their biased mindset against HIV. It aims to try to influence perception and cut down stigma

by combining 2D animation, realistic dialogue, and symbolic visuals; this therefore agrees with the advocacy to promote HIV awareness through creative digital media.

2. 2D Animation on HIV Related Stigma.

The characters were created using Photoshop for various tools. It is widely used for character creation and digital designs.

Figure 4, the protagonist of the short film “More Than HIV,” is a 22-year-old working college student, member of LGBTQ community who has been living with his reality in the Philippines. His character design brings forward that he is quiet, thoughtful, and determined, just like any other young man who caries both emotional and physical burdens, in trying to live a normal life despite the stigma associated with his condition. His daily schedule well tells the trial of balancing academics and part-time work, reflecting resilience and perseverance. Mark's character is a representation of the stigma placed on individuals because of educational, workplace, and community factors.



Figure 4. Mark Dela Cruz

Figure 5 shows Mark's classmates, the supporting characters in the short film "More Than HIV." They epitomize the function of educational stigma in the story, showing how informed prejudice and misinformed judgments may come into play even in everyday academic settings. Both are designed as

typical college students-a young woman and a young man-wearing casual university attire. The quiet judgment of the female classmate is a continuous whisper, glancing towards Mark suspiciously, while the male classmate is more vocal, displaying his amusement at rumors surrounding him. This, in turn, reflects how stigma in schools often emanates through gossip and careless remarks rather than open hostility. Meanwhile, in the animation, their facial features are not shown; they are just merely from the back and their faces are covered in shadow. This was a stylistic choice to represent anonymity and collective guilt-to represent that stigma does not come from one person but from a bigger, faceless social mindset.

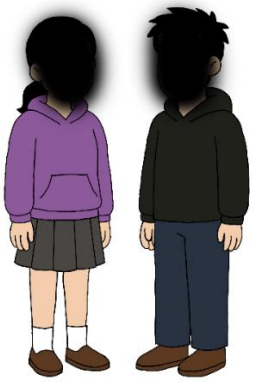


Figure 5. Classmates

Figure 6 presents the Manager; he is a supporting character in the short film “More Than HIV,” where he characterizes stigma in the workplace for the person living with HIV. He is essential in showing how discrimination can take place in people's workplaces, too. The character of the Manager is an average middle-aged man dressed in a simple polo shirt and apron; he symbolizes his status in a small restaurant setting and maintains a very realistic character design. His dialogue and actions reflect internal struggle-things that seem smooth, professional, and calm are combined with words that reflect discomfort

and prejudice about Mark's condition. This subtle juxtaposition was written to express how biases in the workplace often hide behind a mask of "practical" or "necessary" decisions even when they are founded on fear and misinformation.

In the animation, the Manager's face is purposefully kept in shadow and partly obscured to symbolize socially produced ignorance and moral blindness. By hiding his face, the film makes a point that stigma is not an attribute of one person but a system of silent discrimination, faceless and nameless. This creative choice diverts the viewer's attention to Mark's emotional response-shock, sadness, and quiet resignation-rather than the Manager's individual identity. The Manager's character is really important in revealing how the stigma of employment has forced them to face not only economic loss but also the emotional cost associated with rejection. His character carried the story of how most of our prejudice is rooted in misunderstanding rather than malice-a recurring theme in the short film as it explores societal stigma.



Figure 6. Manager

Figure 7 presents two characters, Mark's neighbors—a middle-aged woman and an elderly man—both of whom typify community stigma in the short film "More Than HIV." Both characters symbolize the extent to which prejudice and discrimination against people living with HIV could even become part of the

local environment and social exchange. Their design and behavior are elaborated by how misinformation, gossip, and moral judgment can play a role in the isolation and emotional distress of those affected. The neighbors in the story were regular members of a Filipino community wearing ordinary, everyday clothes. The adult woman character is filled with gossiping as almost every community member does; the older man shows traditional moral beliefs and misconceptions about HIV that were prevalent in generations. Their casual talking of Mark as he passed by brought out the deep-seated biases still inherent in society. Throughout the animation, both characters remained they’re faces shrouded in dark shadow or black tones, symbolizing how stigma often comes from faceless voices that can't be seen or called to account but have deep, tearing pain. It also brings forth the idea that community stigma does not necessarily emanate from one person but often emanates from a collective culture of silence, fear, and moral judgment. Obscuring the features puts the emotional burden on Mark, so the audience is taken through a journey of isolation and humiliation with him. These neighboring characters are very important narratively in the light of envisioning how discrimination could emanate from one's very own surroundings—the people who are supposed to provide belonging and support. Their dialogue and presence deepen emotional intensity in Mark's journey, really underlining how social prejudice remains alive in everyday spaces.

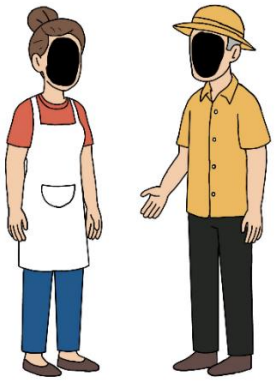


Figure 7. Neighbors

Figure 8, Introduction of a young lady from the HIV support group who is a major supporting character in the short film “More Than HIV.” She represents hope, understanding, and acceptance of the community in choosing compassion over judgment. This character plays an important role in the road to emotional healing and acceptance of Mark after he experiences several forms of stigma. The woman is Art-designed to look warm and approachable, in casual but bright clothes that reflect positivity and reassurance. Her gentle facial expressions and calm demeanor reflect sharply against the cold Mark experienced earlier in the story. Her soft tone and kind gestures speak empathy and understanding—included, belonging that Mark had lost because of discrimination.

In the animation, she is the first person who speaks kindly to Mark after his period of isolation. Their little exchange represents a turning point in this story — just that place where Mark really starts to realize there is life, hope, and community beyond the stigma of HIV. Her dialogue speaks volumes of encouragement and factual understanding that education and compassion can replace fear and prejudice. Visually, the support group meeting is warm in lighting and softer in tone to convey recovery and safety. This character's

design and role drew inspiration from insights by HIV awareness advocates and mental health professionals, who pinpoint the help of peer support and counseling as very important for people living with HIV. Her addition brings an emotional touch to the film's storyline and reiterates the key point of the film: nobody should be defined by their illness, and a little understanding can go a long way.



Figure 8. Support Group Member

3. Technology Acceptance Model Evaluation Results.

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 6 shows the perceived usefulness of the 2D animated video as rated by the respondents. With a composite mean of 4.5 and a standard deviation of 0.63, interpreted as “Strongly Agree,” the results of this study indicate that the video was very effective in creating awareness and understanding of HIV-related stigma. The respondents strongly agreed that by watching this film, they were able to realize how stigma affects the lives of people living with HIV, and the information presented in the animation could be very useful for awareness purposes. Moreover, the short film is considered excellent educational material worthy of being used in advocacy and awareness drives. This thus confirms that the purpose of the 2D animated video—to

educate viewers more about HIV stigma, appreciate their empathetic concerns, and further understand the issue—was very well served.

Table 6. Perceived Usefulness (PU) based on the Respondents' Response

STATEMENTS	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
The short film increased my understanding of HIV-related stigma.	4.6	0.63	Strongly Agree
The story helped me realize how stigma affects people living with HIV.	4.6	0.62	Strongly Agree
The information presented in the film is useful for HIV stigma awareness.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
The film can be used as an educational material for awareness campaigns.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
COMPOCITE MEAN	**4.5**	**0.63**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend: 1= Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Agree, 4 = Strongly Agree

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 7 shows the extent of the respondents' agreement regarding the Perceived Ease of Use of the 2D animated video. With a composite mean of 4.6 and a standard deviation of 0.55, interpreted as “Strongly Agree,” the results showed that the video was clear, interesting, and easy to follow. The responses strongly agreed that the story was simple to understand, the images and animations supported the message well, and the dialogues were clear and moderately paced. The comfortable pacing of the scenes further contributed to a positive viewing experience. These results confirm that the design of the video

was structured in such a way that the flow of the visuals and the content provided no obstacle to comprehension, while maintaining viewer interest. Overall, the results confirm that the 2D animated video was user-friendly and appropriately drafted for communicating its message on HIV stigma awareness effectively.

Table 7. Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU) based on the Respondents Response

STATEMENT	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRATION
The story was easy to understand and follow.	4.6	0.55	Strongly Agree
The visuals and animations helped me understand the message better.	4.6	0.62	Strongly Agree
The dialogues were clear.	4.5	0.51	Strongly Agree
The pacing of the scenes made it comfortable to watch.	4.6	0.50	Strongly Agree
COMPOSITE MEAN	**4.6**	**0.55**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend 1 = Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Agree, 4 = Strongly Agree

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 8 shows the respondents' level of agreement in response to statements that highlight their Attitude Toward Using (ATU) the 2D animated video. With a composite mean of 4.5 and a standard deviation of 0.63, interpreted as “Strongly Agree,” the results show that viewers developed a very positive attitude toward the short film. The respondents strongly agreed that

they liked watching the video and had become more understanding of people living with HIV after watching the video. They also felt that the video depicted HIV-related stigma in the Philippines in a respectful and humane manner. What's more, the video made them contemplate their own judgments about people with HIV. This suggests that the 2D animated film was both emotionally engaging and informative, facilitated empathy, and raised awareness confirmation that this film is indeed a potent tool for enhancing understanding while reducing stigma about HIV.

Table 8. Attitude Toward Using (ATU) based on the Respondent's Response

STATEMENT	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRATION
I enjoyed watching the short film.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
The short film made me feel more empathetic toward people with HIV.	4.5	0.68	Strongly Agree
I believe the film presents HIV Pinoy stigma in a respectful and human way.	4.6	0.56	Strongly Agree
The film motivated me to think about how I view people with HIV.	4.5	0.62	Strongly Agree
COMPOSITE MEAN	**4.5**	**0.63**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend1= Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Agree, 4 = Strongly Agree

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 9 shows the level of agreement by the respondents in terms of their Behavioral Intention with respect to viewing the 2D animated video. In fact, with a composite mean of 4.4 and a standard deviation of 0.88, interpreted as

“Strongly Agree,” the respondents believe that the video had a great influence on enhancing viewers' behavioral intentions. The statements to which the respondents strongly agreed include: they are more willing to support HIV awareness, and that they can recommend the short film to others after watching it. They also agreed that the video encouraged them to be more understanding and compassionate toward people living with HIV. These prove that the 2D animated video successfully influences viewers to think and act positively—to create awareness and show empathy—which further proves that this is another successful educational and advocacy tool against HIV stigma.

Table 9. Behavioral Intention (BI) based on the Respondents' Response

STATEMENT	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRATATION
I am more likely to support HIV awareness after watching the film.	4.4	0.93	Strongly Agree
I will recommend this short film to others.	4.5	0.82	Strongly Agree
The film encouraged me to be more understanding toward people living with HIV.	4.4	0.90	Strongly Agree
COMPOSITE MEAN	**4.4**	**0.88**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend: 1=Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Agree, 4 = Strongly Agree

CHAPTER V

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION, AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter summarizes the study's objectives, methods, development, testing, and results. It also highlights the key findings and provides recommendations to further improve the project's effectiveness and success.

Summary of Findings

The project centers on creating a 2D animated film in a way that increases the awareness of HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. It aligns with SDG 3: Good Health and Well-Being, SDG 5: Gender Equality, and SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities, which highlight access to health information, equality, and protection against discrimination for all. The animation tackles the emotional, social, and psychological impact of stigma faced by people living with HIV while fostering empathy, understanding, and acceptance in society. The goal of this 2D animation project is to showcase stories inspired by real-life experiences that depict various forms of HIV stigma, emphasizing compassion and reduction of stigma. The film aims to encourage viewers, particularly college students, to reflect on their perceptions and develop greater respect, inclusivity, and support for people living with HIV.

The project moved through different stages to keep the story clear and real. Info came from HIV stigma documentaries in the Philippines, and interview with people who’ve faced stigma around HIV. From what we found, a solid script plus visuals were mapped out. The animation got built with digital drawing tools or programs made for motion art, while voice performers followed a set script, so characters felt alive. Audio bits - like mood music or small sound details - were mixed in through a focus on feeling, making the whole thing hit harder.

To check how well the project worked, researchers applied the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), focusing on how useful people found it, how easy they thought it was to use, their overall feelings about it, along with their willingness to use it again. Thirty participants took part in a survey that collected opinions about the 2D Animation's clearness, learning benefits, ability to hold attention, as well as its effect on emotions.

The findings showed people welcomed it well, plus reactions were clearly favorable - proof the 2D Animation effectively boosted insight about HIV stigma. Most audience members felt sure it expanded their grasp of the topic while shifting how they see things, also pushing them to stand by those affected by HIV. The results suggest the initiative successfully brought together straightforward narratives, heartfelt emotion, OR educational value to meet its aim - lessening stigma while encouraging empathy. Good feedback highlights how 2D animation can serve as an impactful way to teach, drive change, or boost public understanding.

Conclusion

This study successfully developed, tested, and evaluated the 2D animated video titled *"More Than HIV"*, which aims to raise awareness and reduce HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. The animation underwent a structured process including research, gathering data from video documentaries and through interview with people living with HIV, scriptwriting, character design development, and storyboard creation to ensure accurate representation of HIV issues and socially relevant narratives.

To assess the 2D Animation effectiveness, the final animation was evaluated by 30 college students. Feedback highlighted the video's success in

common misconceptions, and portraying stigma-related experiences with sensitivity. Respondents emphasized its emotional impact and clarity in presenting the realities faced by individuals affected by HIV. Using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), the project obtained an overall acceptance rating of 4.5, indicating that the video is useful, understandable, and engaging for general audiences.

1. **Identify key information on HIV stigma to include in the animation**

Essential information about HIV stigma, and common misconceptions was gathered through interview with people living with HIV (PLHIV) and analysis of 21 video documentaries on HIV stigma in the Philippines. These firsthand accounts and real-world narratives provided authentic insights into lived experiences, discrimination challenges, and emotional impacts, ensuring that the storyline and messaging were grounded in real-life Filipino contexts and voices.

2. **Develop characters and narrative based on gathered data**

Characters and storyline elements were conceptualized based on the gathered insights, representing common stigma scenarios faced by PLHIV in the Philippines. Digital illustrations using Adobe Photoshop reflected diverse backgrounds and emotional expressions, while the script and storyboard were created to depict realistic experiences and lessons promoting empathy and understanding.

3. **Evaluate the 2D animated video using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)**

The survey, created with expert consultation, collected feedback from 30 college student in LSPU Los Baños respondents. The 2D animated short film received an overall TAM acceptance score of 4.5, indicating that the video is effective in enhancing awareness, reshaping perceptions, and encouraging acceptance and compassion toward people living with HIV.

Recommendations

Based on the findings, evaluation results, and feedback gathered from respondents, the following recommendations are proposed to strengthen the impact, reach, and future development of the 2D animated video addressing HIV stigma in the Philippines:

1. Utilize the animated video as educational material in health-related courses, community outreach programs, and seminars focused on HIV awareness, stigma reduction, and sexual health education.
2. Collaborate with local health units, NGOs, and advocacy groups such as DOH, LoveYourself PH, and community-based organizations to integrate the video into their HIV information campaigns and counselling sessions.
3. Conduct further studies using a larger and more diverse sample size to better evaluate the video's effectiveness across different demographics—including youth, adults, and community workers.
4. Enhance future production with improved audio, character animation, and visual storytelling, using programs such as Toon Boom, Adobe

Animate, Blendr (for 2D/2.5D integration), and professional sound design tools.

5. Develop additional animated episodes or sequels focusing on broader HIV topics such as prevention methods, treatment (ART), U=U (Undetectable = Untransmittable), myths and facts, and lived experiences of people living with HIV.

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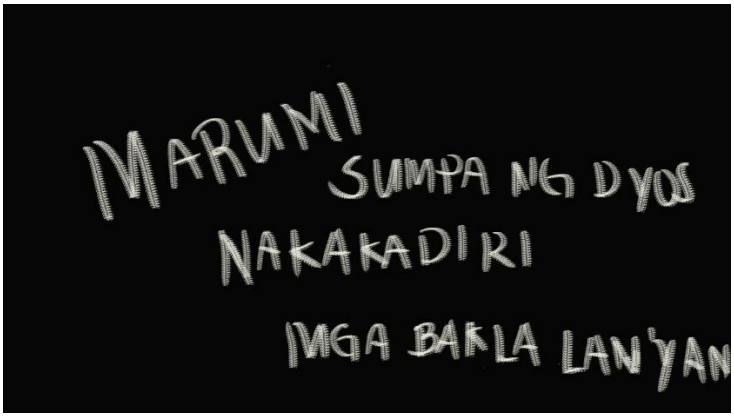
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APPENDIX

A

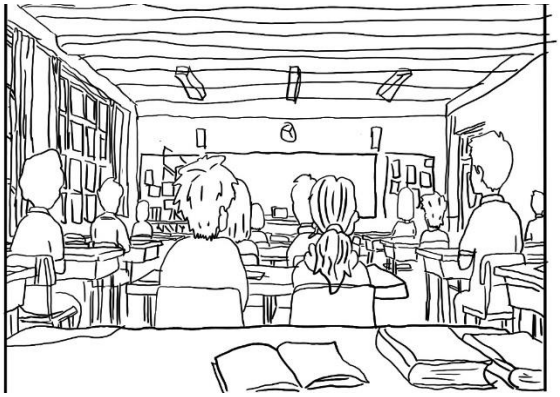
STORYBOARD



In the opening scene, harsh, white handwritten words appear against a dark black background, floating like haunting whispers in empty space. Hurtful labels such as *“Marumi,” “Nakakadiri,” “Sumpa ng Diyos,”* and *“Mga bakla lang ’yan”* fill the screen, shaking slightly as if spoken with anger and fear. The darkness and distorted text create a tense, heavy mood, showing how stigma surrounds and attacks even before we see the character.



Mark sits alone on a bench in the hospital, his back slightly hunched as he clutches the paper in his trembling hands. The words “HIV POSITIVE” stare back at him, heavy and overwhelming. His body shakes, showing shock and fear. The empty space around him emphasizes his isolation — even in a public place, he feels completely alone as the reality of his diagnosis sinks in.



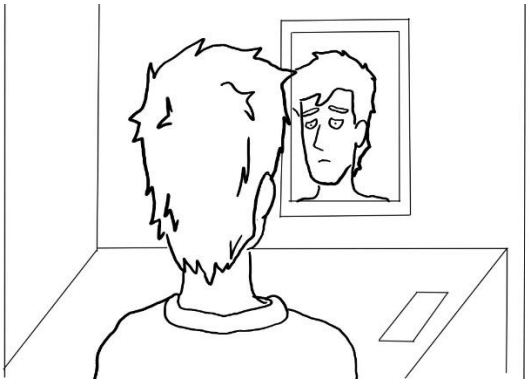
In this classroom scene, students sit quietly facing the front, surrounded by books and school materials. Mark is seated among them, but the atmosphere feels tense and distant. Though he is in a room full of people, he appears isolated, disconnected from the lively classroom environment. This setting introduces the school stigma he faces — a place that should feel safe and normal, but instead becomes a space where judgment, whispers, and silent exclusion begin to surround him.



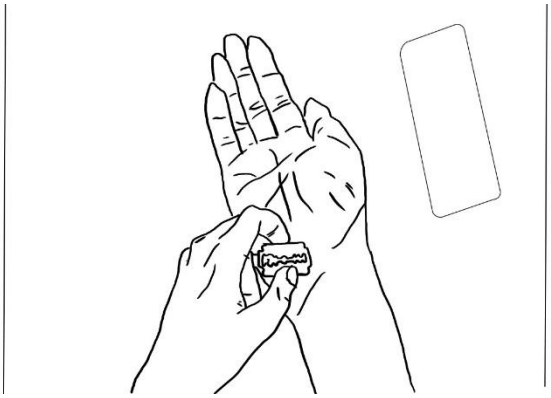
In the workplace scene, Mark stands in the kitchen wearing his apron as his manager quietly talks to him. Instead of support, Mark is met with fear and judgment. The place where he works hard and should feel valued becomes another space where he is pushed away and treated unfairly because of his condition.



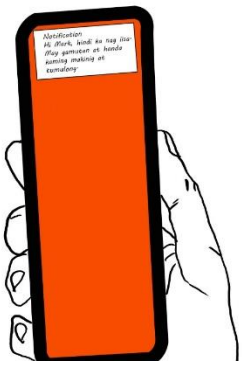
In the community scene, Mark walks down the street, hoping to feel normal. Neighbors whisper, instead of being part of a supportive neighborhood, Mark feels like an outsider in his own community. The familiar streets now feel cold and unwelcoming, showing how stigma can follow someone everywhere, even in places that should feel like home.



In this scene, Mark sits alone, quietly staring at his reflection. The room is still, yet his mind is loud. Doubts and painful words echo inside him — not from others this time, but from himself. He holds his chest, struggling with sadness and fear, as he begins to believe the hurtful things society says. Instead of seeing his strength, he only sees shame. This moment shows how stigma can become internal, turning into a quiet battle within.



In this scene, Mark feels completely defeated and believing he has no strength left. His hands shake, as if trying to escape the heavy thoughts pulling him down. The world around him feels dark and silent, and he thinks about giving up — not because he wants to die, but because he is tired of hurting. Just as he breaks down, a small glimmer of light enters the frame — a reminder that even in his darkest moment, hope and help still exist.



In this scene suddenly, his phone rang beside him. He hesitates before picking it up, and on the screen, he sees a message from an HIV support group: *“Hindi ka nag-iisa. May gamutan. At handa kaming makinig at tumulong.”* His trembling hands relax. For the first time, he feels that someone understands — he is not alone.



In this scene, Mark enters a small support group room, nervous and unsure. But he is greeted with gentle smiles and welcoming faces — people of different ages and backgrounds who, like him, are living with HIV. They sit together in a circle, talking, laughing softly, and sharing stories. Someone reaches out, offering comfort and understanding. For the first time, he feels accepted and seen. The room is calm and bright, filled with warmth and hope, showing that healing begins when people stand together.

“Magkaisa tayo laban sa stigma.”
“Suporta, hindi diskriminasyon.”

In the final scene, the screen fades to a clean white background. Calm, hopeful music plays as powerful text slowly appears: “Magkaisa tayo laban sa Stigma. Supporta, hindi diskriminasyon.” The message is gentle yet strong — a reminder of dignity, compassion, and understanding. The film ends on a soft, hopeful note, leaving viewers with a sense of awareness, empathy, and encouragement to care instead of judge.

APPENDIX

B

CHARACTER DESIGN



Mark is a 22-year-old Filipino working college student and a member of the LGBTQ community. His character design reflects a young person quietly struggling to balance his studies, part-time work, and the emotional burden of living with HIV in the Philippines. He appears humble and reserved — often seen carrying a backpack, symbolizing his determination to build a better future despite hardships and social judgment. Mark typically wears simple, neat, everyday clothes to show that he is practical, hardworking, and grounded. His posture is slightly withdrawn, and his tired eyes reveal the weight of stress, fear, and stigma he carries. Overall, Mark's character represents resilience. He embodies the quiet strength of individuals who face discrimination in school, work, and society. Through his journey, he shows that people living with HIV are more than their diagnosis — they are individuals with dignity, dreams, and the courage to keep going.

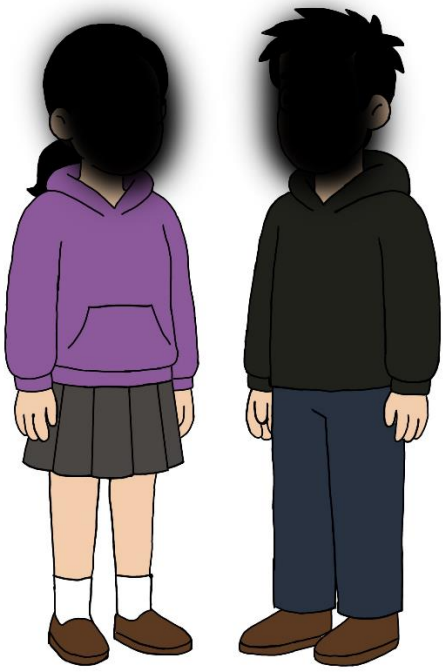


Figure 15 shows Mark's classmates, supporting characters who represent educational stigma in *"More Than HIV."* Designed as ordinary college students in casual attire, they reflect how discrimination can quietly exist in everyday school environments. The female classmate shows silent judgment through suspicious looks and whispers, while the male classmate expresses stigma more openly through careless comments and reactions to rumors. Their faces are intentionally hidden, symbolizing that stigma in school is not caused by one person, but by a collective, anonymous mindset shaped by ignorance and social attitudes.



The Manager in *“More Than HIV”* represents workplace stigma faced by people living with HIV. His simple attire reflects his role in a small restaurant and emphasizes a realistic, everyday setting where discrimination can quietly occur. The deliberate choice to obscure his face symbolizes how stigma is often impersonal and rooted in social ignorance rather than individual malice. This design highlights the emotional impact on Mark and underscores the film’s message that discrimination often stems from misinformation, not intention.

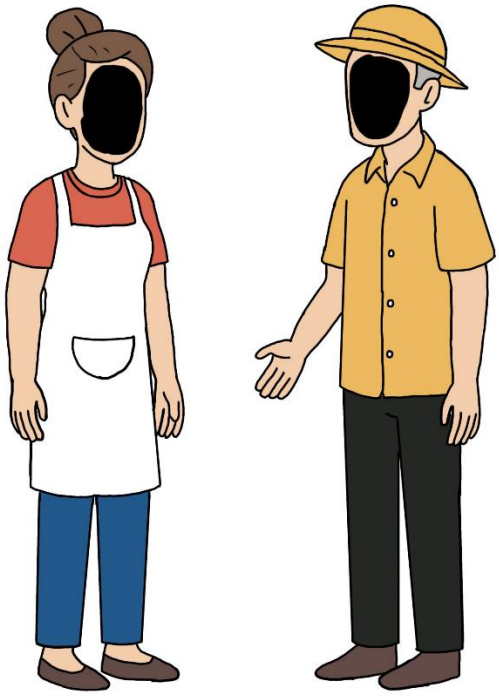


Figure 17 shows Mark's neighbors—an older woman and an elderly man—who represent community stigma in *"More Than HIV."* Their simple, everyday clothing reflects typical Filipino community members, emphasizing how discrimination can exist in familiar, ordinary surroundings. The woman symbolizes gossip and social chatter, while the older man reflects traditional beliefs and misconceptions about HIV. Their faces are intentionally shadowed to represent a faceless, collective source of stigma—one rooted in fear, judgment, and silence rather than a single person. This design highlights how community prejudice isolates individuals and adds emotional weight to Mark's journey, grounding the film in real Filipino experiences and social dynamics.



Figure 18 introduces a young woman from the HIV support group who represents hope, compassion, and acceptance in *“More Than HIV.”* Designed with a warm and approachable look, she wears casual but bright clothing to symbolize positivity and emotional support. Her gentle expressions and calm presence contrast the cold treatment Mark experienced earlier, showing that kindness can be powerful healing. She is the first character to speak to Mark with empathy, marking a turning point in his journey toward self-acceptance and recovery. Her design and role emphasize the importance of supportive communities and remind viewers that understanding—not judgment—can change lives.

APPENDIX

C

SCRIPT

“More Than HIV” – Short Film Script
2D Animated Short

OPENING SCENE – SHADOWS OF WHISPERS

INT. VOID / BLACK BACKGROUND

VISUALS:
Complete darkness. Quiet. Then faint text appears one by one in the black void.

Over lapping words:
“Marumi.”
“Kasalanan nila.”
“Mga bakla lang ‘yan.”
“Sumpa ng Diyos.”

The words distort and enlarge, pressing inward like walls.
Everything collapses suddenly into pure black silence.

CUT TO:
Mark holding an HIV test result, hands trembling, fear in his eyes.

SCENE 1 – THE CLASSROOM (EDUCATIONAL STIGMA)

INT. COLLEGE CLASSROOM – DAY

A lively room. Students chatting.
Mark (22, student) sitting quietly, books clutched to his chest.

Two classmates whisper.

CLASSMATE 1 (whispering):
“Tinanggalan daw ng scholarship…”

CLASSMATE 2 (snickering):
“Siguro kung kani-kanino siya nakikipagrelasyon.”

CLASSMATE 1 (whispering):
“Iwasan natin baka mahawaan tayo.”

VISUALS:
Mark sits. Whispering continues.
Close-up: Mark bows his head, trying to hold back tears.

SCENE 2 – THE WORKPLACE (EMPLOYMENT STIGMA)

INT. SMALL RESTAURANT KITCHEN – DAY

Clatter of plates. Mark working in apron.
Manager approaches awkwardly.

MANAGER (low voice):
“Mark… pasensya na. Hindi lahat nakakaintindi sa kondisyon mo. Kailangan na nating tapusin ang kontrata mo.”

VISUALS:
Mark freezes.

SCENE 3 – THE STREET (COMMUNITY STIGMA)

EXT. SARI-SARI STORE / BARANGAY – DAY

Mark walks past neighbors.

NEIGHBOR 1:
“Bakla kasi kaya may HIV.”

NEIGHBOR 2:
“Sumpa ng Diyos ‘yan. Dapat lang.”

Mark quickens pace, head down.
Faces of neighbors distorted into dark silhouettes.

SCENE 4 – THE MIRROR (SELF-STIGMA)

INT. MARK’S ROOM – NIGHT (DIM LIGHT)

Mark sits in front of a mirror, shaking, tired eyes.

VOICES IN HIS HEAD (whispers):

“Marumi.”
“Walang halaga.”
“Mamamatay ka na.”

MARK (weak, broken):
“Kasalanan ko… wala na akong kinabukasan.”

Mark begins to attempt suicide — trembling, emotional collapse.

SCENE 5 – BREAKING THE SILENCE

INT. MARK’S ROOM – CONTINUOUS

A phone notification buzzes on the desk.
Mark slowly looks.

TEXT MESSAGE (on screen):
“Hindi ka nag-iisa. May gamutan at handa kaming makinig at tumulong.”

VISUALS:
Soft warm light from phone.
Mark’s tears slow.

Music shifts to hopeful tones.

SCENE 6 – THE CIRCLE OF STRENGTH

INT. SUPPORT GROUP ROOM – DAY

Mark enters, hesitant.
Inside: a young woman, a mother with child, LGBTQ+ youth, elderly man. Warm smiles.

VOICEOVER – MARK (emotional, firm):
“Hindi kami marumi. Hindi kami sumpa. Kami ay tao — may pangarap, may dignidad, at higit pa sa HIV.”

Mark smiles for the first time. Healing begins.

FINAL SCENE – MESSAGE

WHITE SCREEN – CLEAN, HOPEFUL

TEXT ON SCREEN:
“Magkaisa tayo laban sa stigma. Suporta, hindi diskriminasyon.”

Soft hopeful music ends.

FADE OUT.

APPENDIX

D

COLOR KEYS



The animation opens with a black background, creating a sense of emptiness and isolation. Words such as *“marumi”*, *“nakakadiri”, etc.* Slowly appear and move in a wave-like motion across the screen. This visual choice represents the overwhelming and intrusive nature of stigma, as if the hateful words are closing in and echoing inside the protagonist’s mind.



Next, Mark appears on screen holding his HIV test result, showing a positive status. His hands tremble as he grips the paper, and his body shakes in fear and shock. This moment represents the intense emotional weight of receiving the diagnosis and the overwhelming uncertainty that follows.



In this scene, the screen fades to black, creating a calm pause from the emotional tension. The title of the animation slowly appears at the center, simple and bold. This moment grounds the audience and formally introduces the film's message before the story continues.



An alarm clock rings, signaling the start of Mark's day. The sound cuts through the quiet room, emphasizing routine and normalcy — a reminder that despite his struggles, life continues moving forward. Mark slowly wakes up, showing the emotional heaviness he carries as he prepares to face another day with stigma and fear.

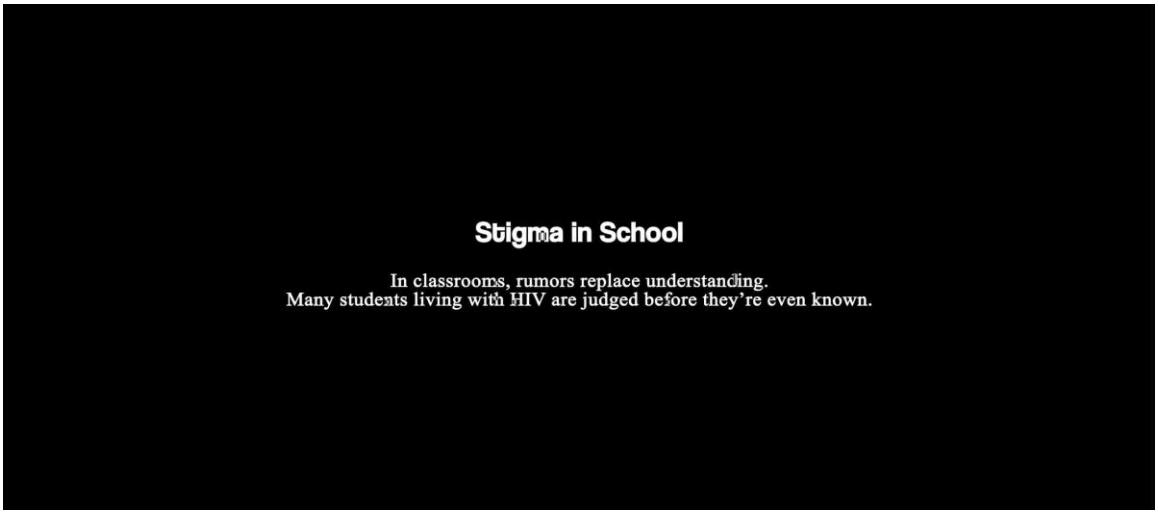


Mark is shown taking a shower as part of his morning routine, preparing himself for another day at school. This scene emphasizes normal daily life and transitions smoothly into his journey outside.

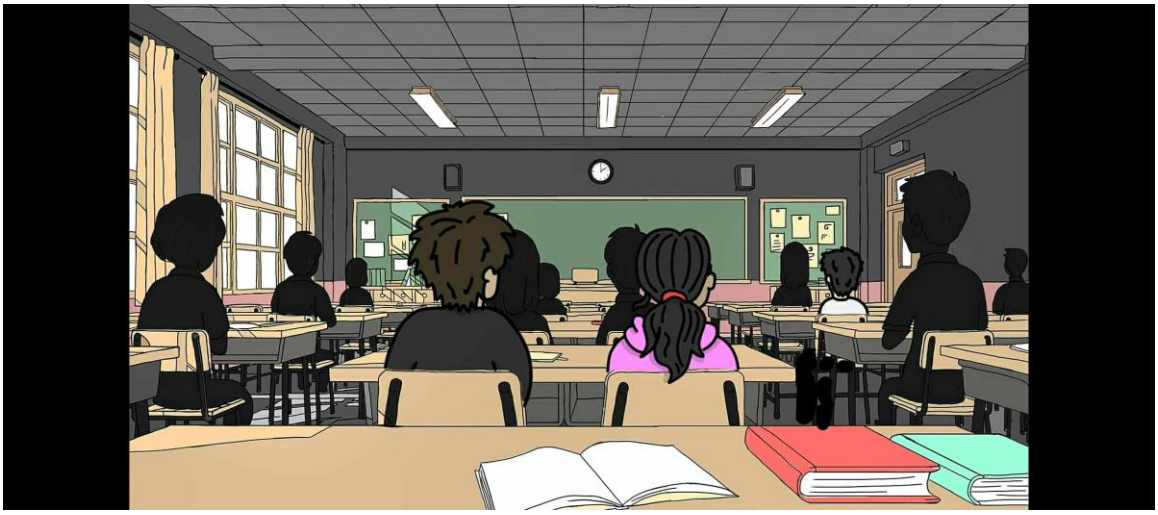




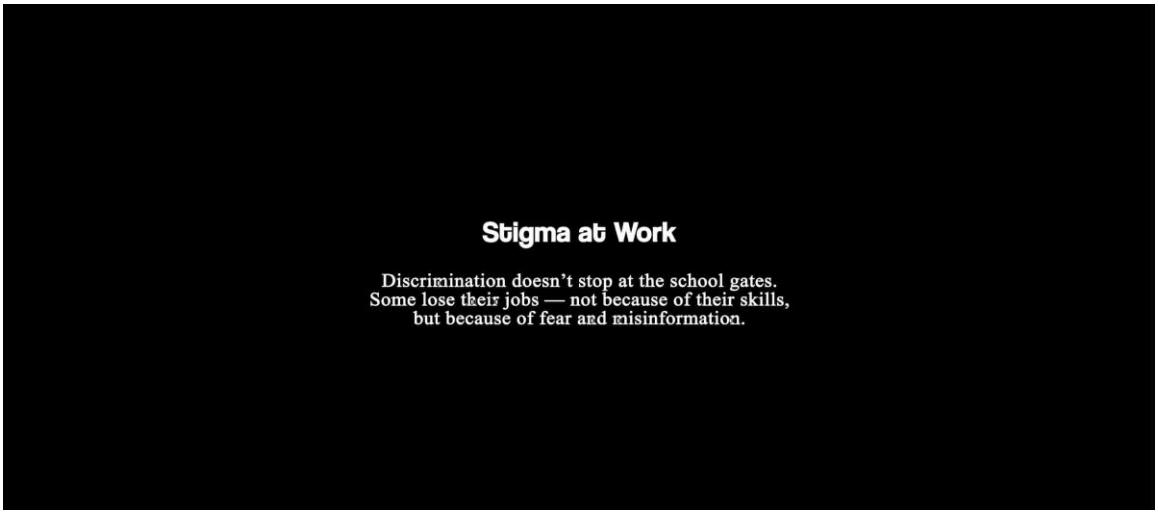
These scenes show Mark commuting to school, riding public transportation with a quiet and tired expression. This moment highlights his ordinary daily routine and the silent weight he carries as he goes through a normal student's day.



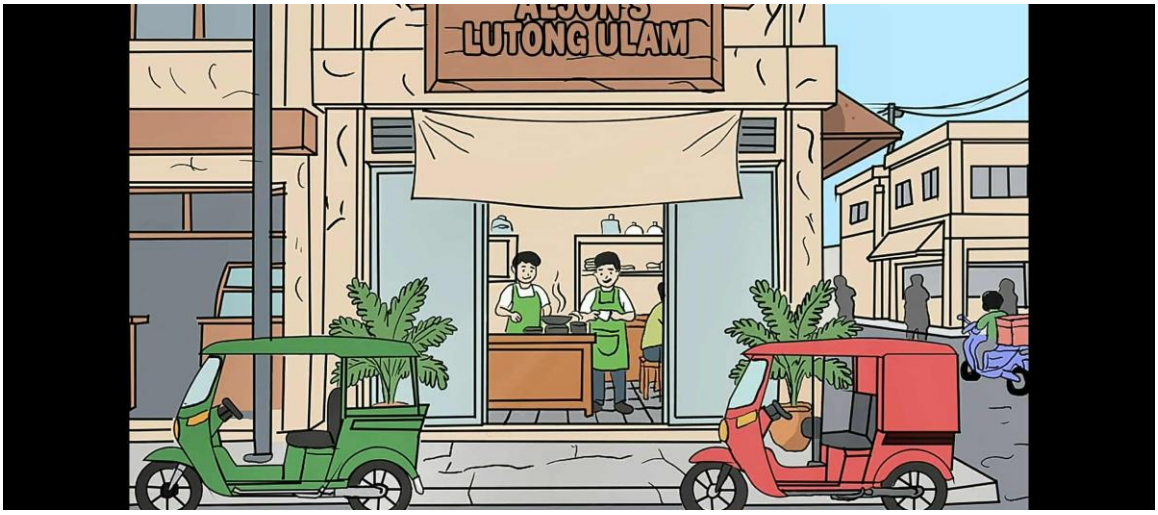
The screen transitions to a clean, simple black background with the text “Stigma in School” appearing in bold. A short explanation fades in beneath it, briefly describing how misconceptions, gossip, and fear inside academic spaces can isolate students living with HIV. This serves as a clear chapter marker, guiding the audience to understand that the following scene reflects educational stigma.



In this scene Mark sits quietly in his classroom, surrounded by his classmates. As whispers and judgmental glances begin to surface, the atmosphere shifts, showing the presence of educational stigma. Even in a normal school setting, Mark feels isolated and singled out, despite trying to focus and appear normal.



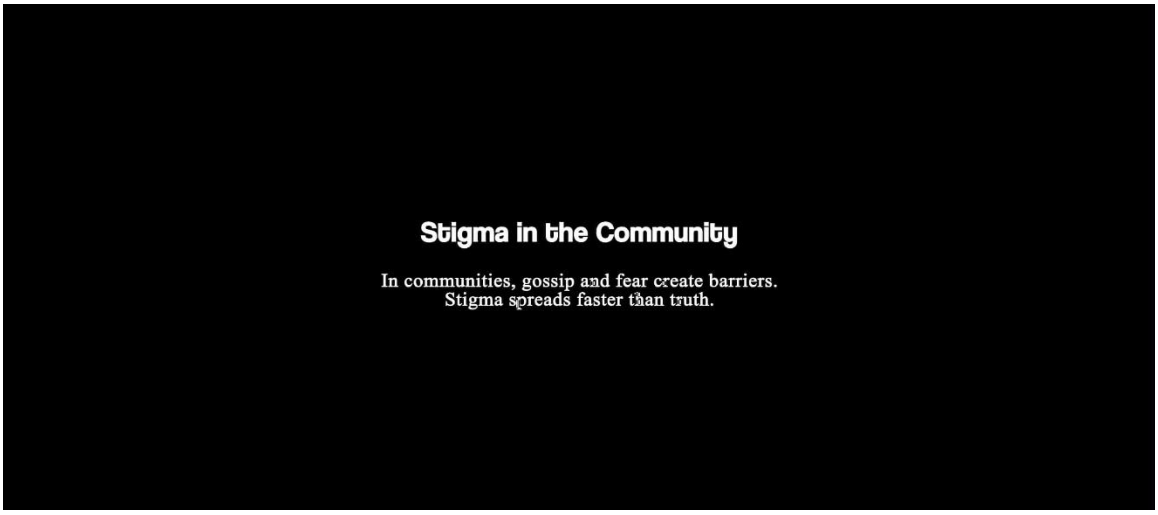
The frame shifts to a black background as the text “Stigma at Work” appears. A brief explanation follows, highlighting how unfair treatment, judgment, and lack of understanding in workplaces can lead to discrimination against people living with HIV. This prepares the audience for the scene showing Mark’s experience in his job environment.



Next scene shows the outside environment of where Mark work, serving as a transition. This part shows his daily routine continuing as he heads to his job, even while silently carrying the weight of stigma.



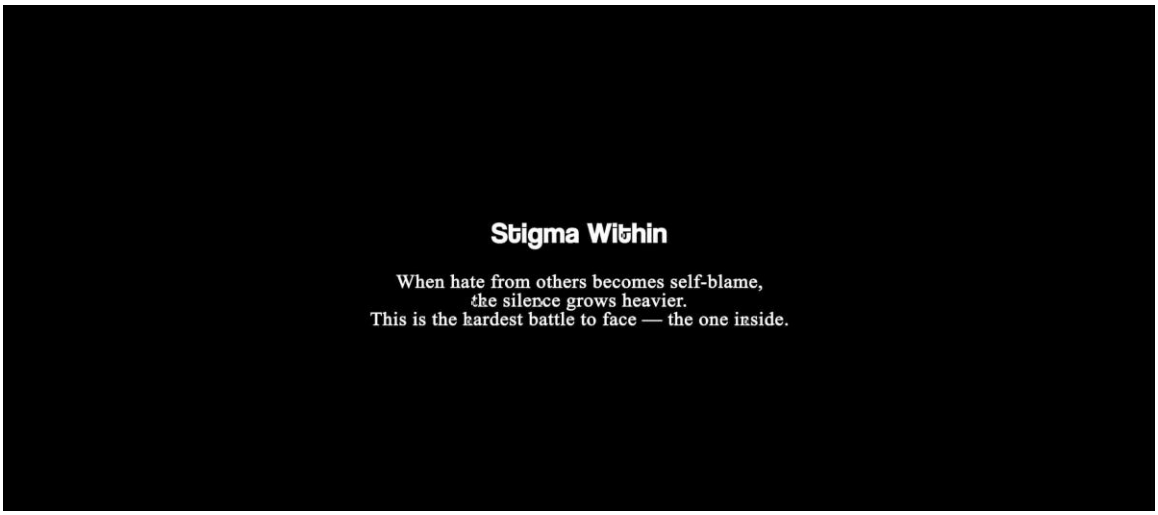
In this scene, Mark is shown working inside a kitchen. The atmosphere feels busy and stressful. The manager approaches him and talks to him privately, explaining that they need to let him go because of his condition. This moment highlights workplace stigma and how discrimination affects Mark's livelihood and sense of dignity.



This scene transitions to a dark background, and the text “Stigma in the Community” appears. A short description follows, explaining how gossip, prejudice, and misinformation in neighborhoods create isolation and shame for people living with HIV. This sets the tone for Mark’s encounter in his own community.



Next, the scene shifts to the community. Mark walks past a sari-sari store in his neighborhood. As he passes by, a group of neighbors quietly gossip and judge him. Their whispers and stares create an uncomfortable atmosphere, showing how stigma exists even in everyday public spaces. This moment reflects community stigma and how hurtful assumptions from others make Mark feel isolated in his own neighborhood.



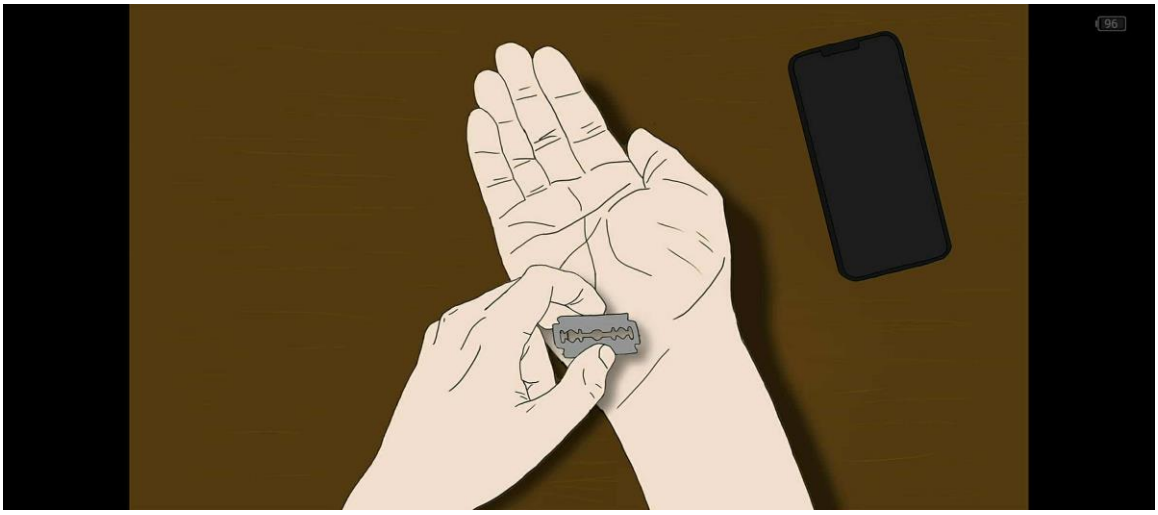
The screen fades to black, and the text “Stigma Within” appears. A brief explanation follows, describing how internalized fear, shame, and self-blame can deeply affect a person living with HIV. This sets the emotional tone for Mark’s upcoming scene, where he battles his own thoughts shaped by the judgment he has faced from others.



The scene transitions to Mark's house at night. Heavy rain pours outside, drumming against the windows and rooftops, creating a cold, isolated atmosphere. The dim lighting inside reflects his emotional state—quiet, heavy, and filled with loneliness. The storm outside mirrors the turmoil Mark feels within as he struggles silently against overwhelming thoughts.



In this scene, as Mark stares into the mirror, faint whispers begin to echo in his mind. The voices grow louder, overlapping—harsh words he has absorbed from society and now turned against himself: *"Marumi."* *"Walang halaga."* *"Kasalanan mo."* These internal voices reflect the deep wound of self-stigma—showing how external judgment can become internal punishment.



With the rain still pounding outside, Mark sits alone in his dim room, the voices in his head now overwhelming and heavy. His hands tremble as he slowly picks up a small blade, holding it close to his wrist. His breathing becomes shaky — not out of anger, but deep exhaustion and emotional pain. In his eyes, there is fear, hopelessness, and silent pleading. This scene shows the intense weight of internal stigma and mental struggle faced by many in silence.



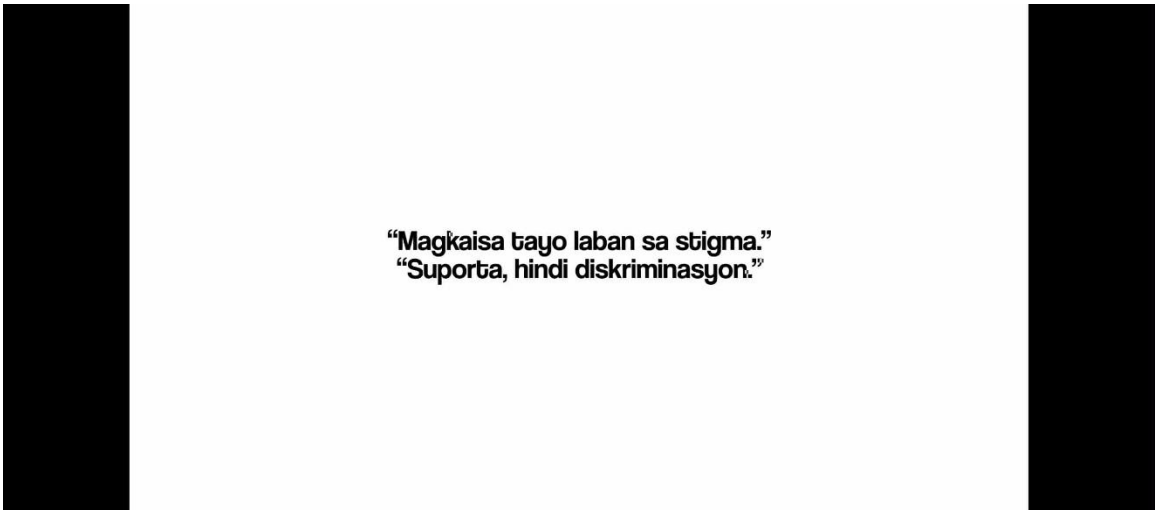
Just as the moment grows darkest, Mark's phone vibrates softly on the desk beside him. The words feel warm against the cold silence of the room. His breathing slows. The noise in his head softens. Hope — faint but real — begins to return as the message reminds him that support exists, and that his life is not alone nor hopeless.



As Mark finishes reading the message. A tear slips down his cheek, followed by another — quiet, trembling. For the first time after all the voices, all the judgment, all the loneliness — he lets himself cry freely.



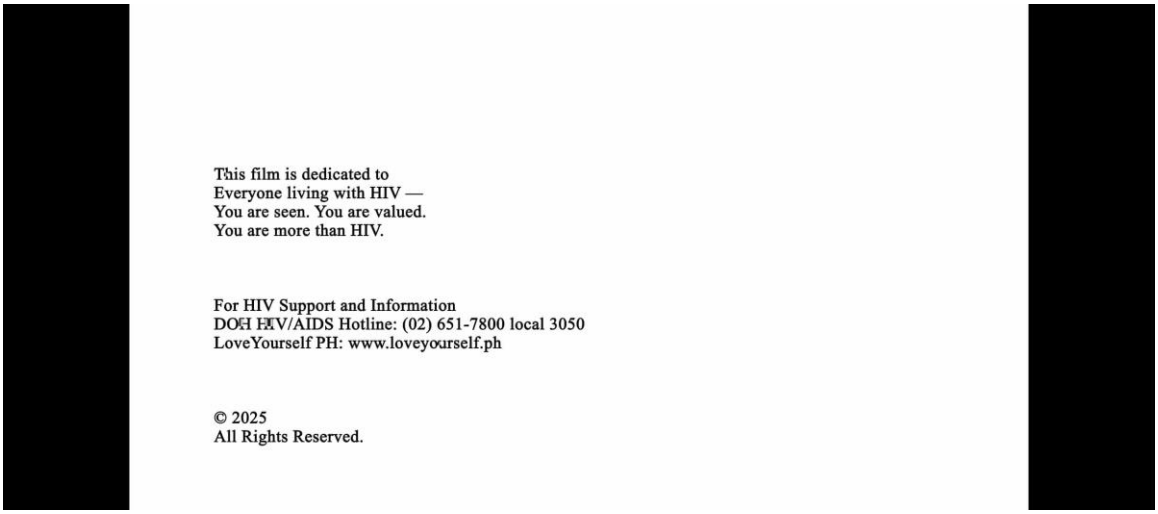
Next scene, Mark in softly lit room, member of the group welcomed him. This time, he lets himself be seen — and accepted.



In the final scene, the screen shifts to a clean white background, symbolizing hope and new beginnings. Simple text appears with the message “Magkaisa tayo laban sa stigma. Suporta, hindi diskriminasyon.”, delivering the film’s core advocacy. This minimalist moment contrasts with earlier darker scenes, emphasizing healing, understanding, and the power of compassion. The scene leaves viewers with a clear reminder that acceptance saves lives and stigma only deepens suffering.



The film ends with a simple credit sequence acknowledging everyone who contributed to the project. Soft, uplifting background music plays, symbolizing hope and renewal after Mark’s emotional journey.

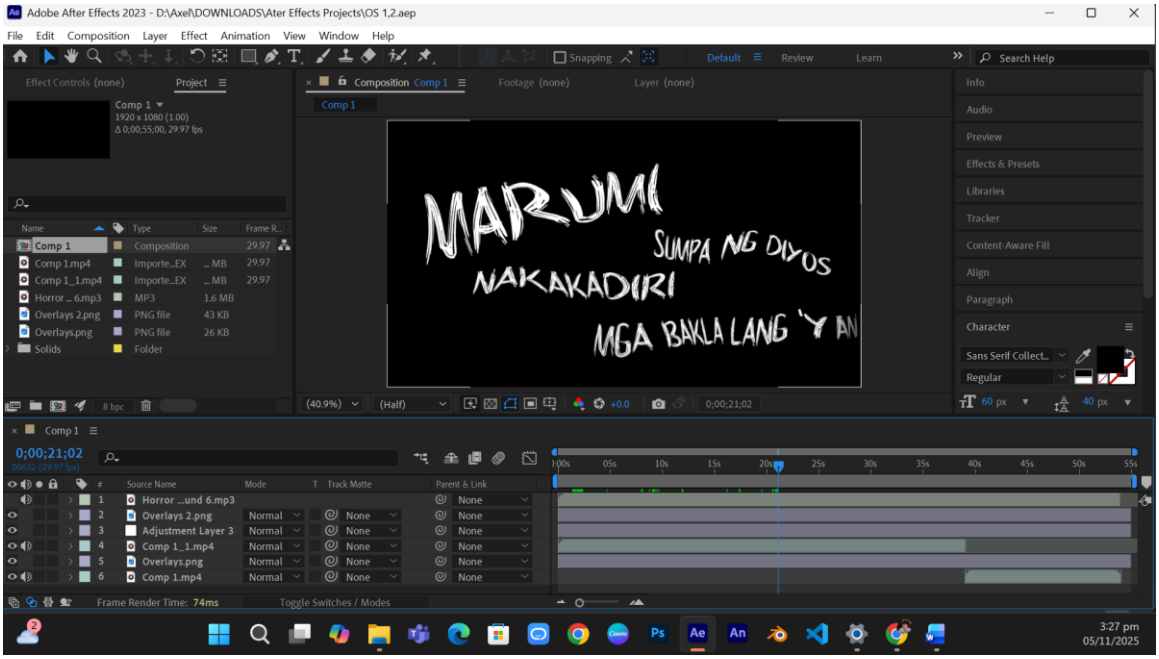


This final scene serves as a closing message of hope and support. After witnessing the stigma and emotional struggles Mark faced, the animation ends by directly addressing people living with HIV, reminding them that they are not alone and that help is available. The screen displays encouraging words and contact information for real support organizations, emphasizing healing, community, and access to care. This moment reinforces the film's advocacy — promoting compassion, awareness, and a commitment to end stigma.

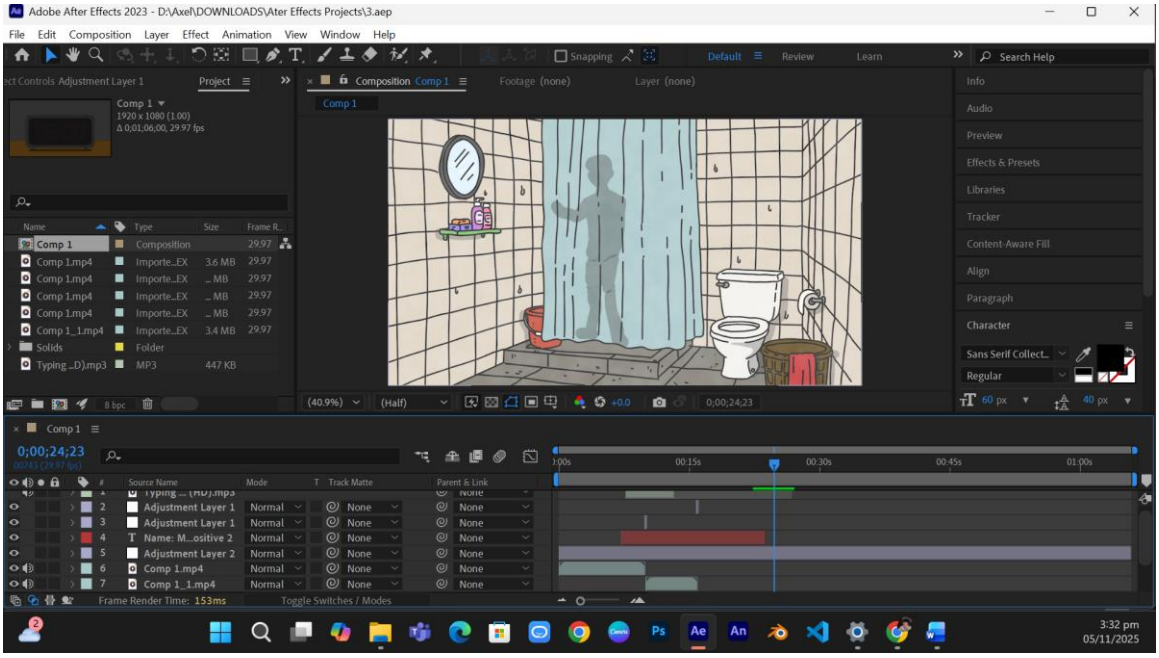
APPENDIX

E

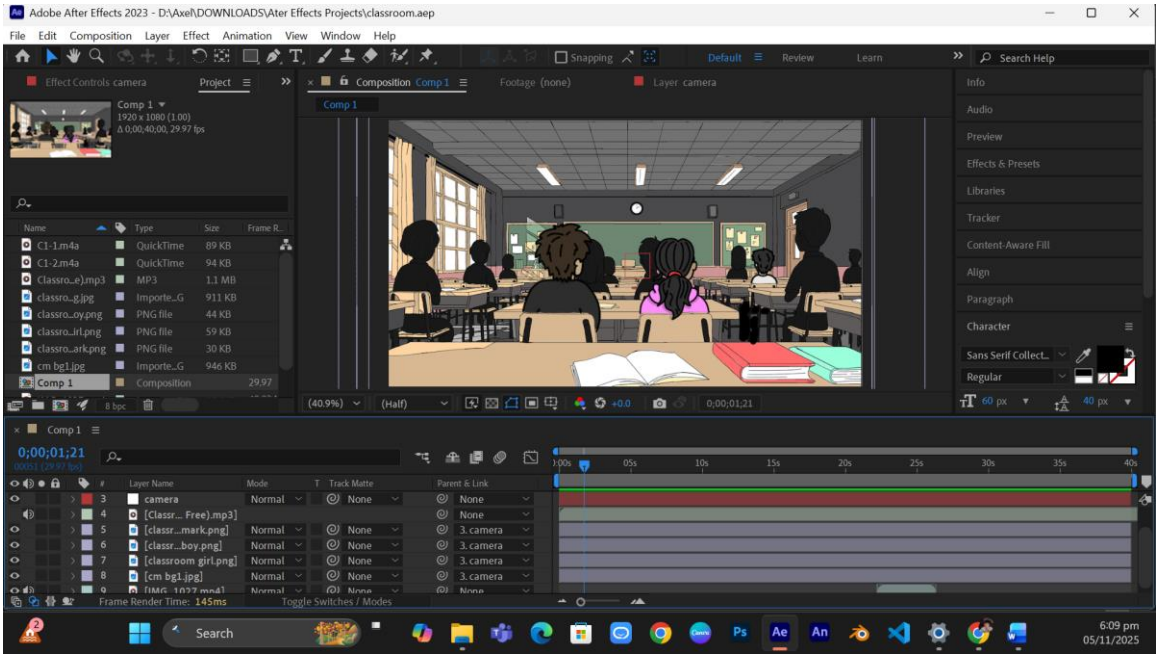
ANIMATION DESIGN



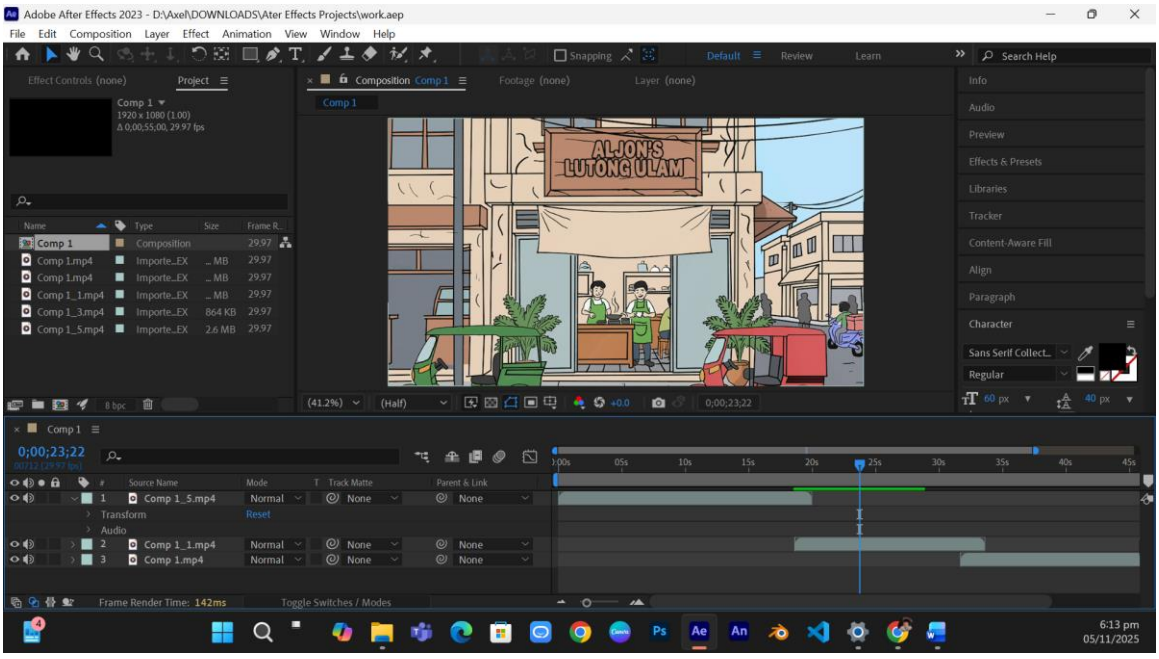
This is the interface of the software used to create the 2D animation. Displayed here is the timeline for the opening scenes, where each frame and movement is organized and animated to build the emotional introduction of the film.



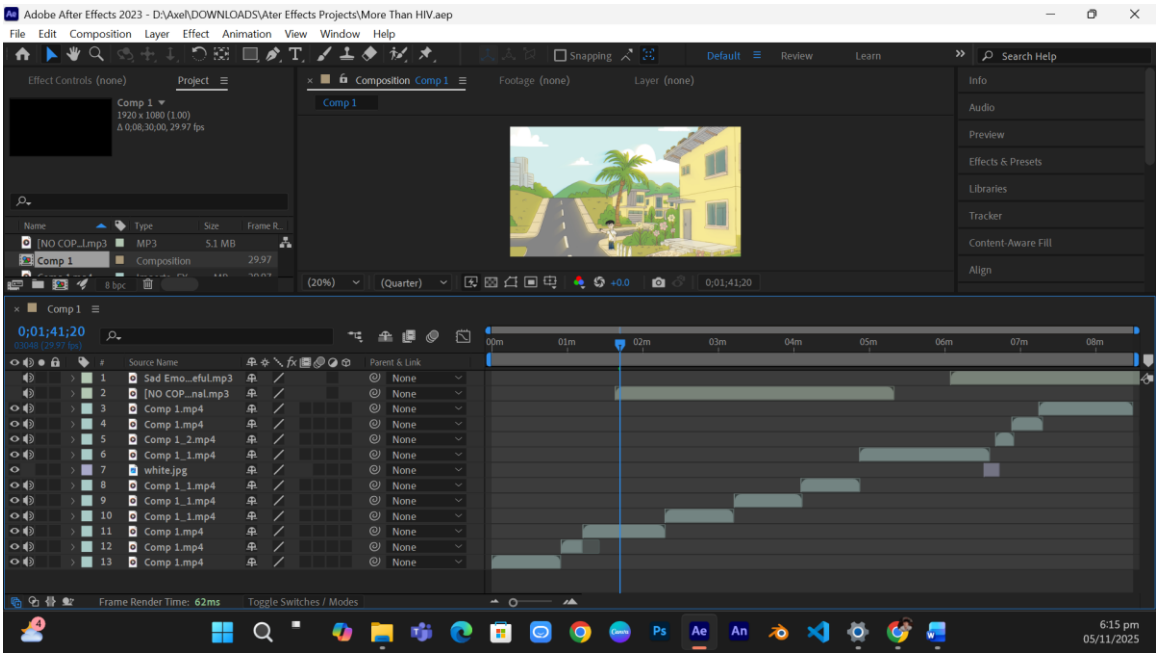
This timeline shows the sequence where Mark prepares to go to school. It includes the key actions and transitions—such as waking up, getting ready, and heading out—establishing his daily routine before the events of stigma begin to unfold.



This is the timeline shows the school stigma scene. It shows how the sequence of shots and actions is arranged to portray Mark's classroom experience and the subtle but hurtful discrimination he faces from his classmates.



This timeline shows the workplace stigma sequence, combining three connected scenes.

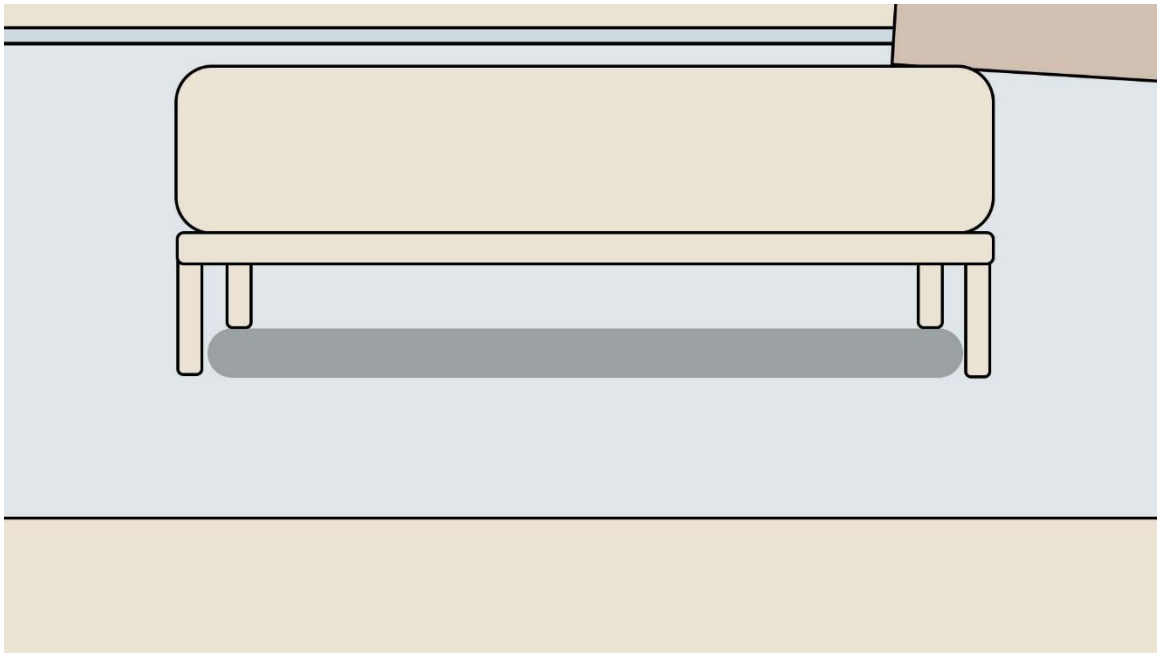


This timeline represents the complete sequence of all scenes in More Than HIV. It shows the final assembly in After Effects, including effects, text animations, movement and positioning, and scene transitions. This stage brings together all visual and emotional elements of the short film into one cohesive narrative.

APPENDIX

F

BACKGROUND SCENES



This is the background used in the scene where Mark holds his HIV test result.



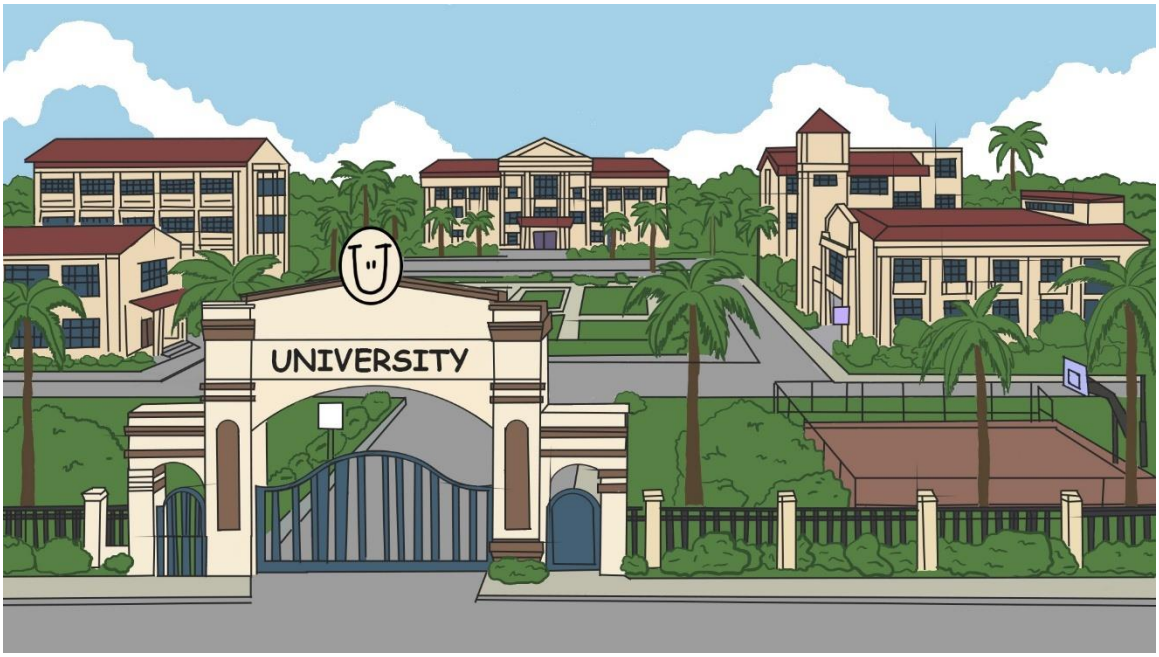
Background of Mark’s room.



Bathroom background used in the scene where Mark prepares for his day.



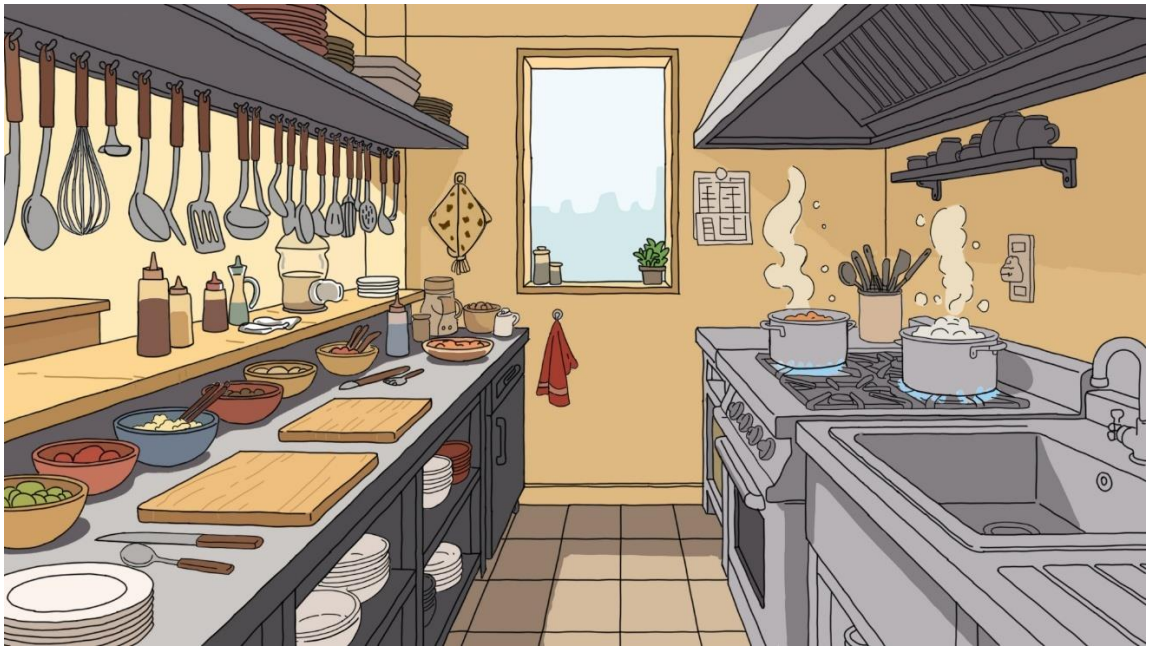
Mark’s house background, where he rides tricycle for transportation.



This background is used to establish that Mark is in school, setting the scene for the moments where he experiences educational stigma from his classmates.



Mark's workplace background, used to show the transition to his work environment.



Kitchen background used for the scene where Mark works.



Barangay sari-sari store background used for the community stigma scene.



Mark’s house at night, used for the “stigma within” scene.



Support group background for the final scene where Mark finds acceptance and support.

APPENDIX

G

PUBLISHABLE PAPERS

More Than HIV: Pinoy Stigma in 2D Animation

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KEYWORDS

HIV stigma
Animation
SDG 3
SDG 5
SDG 10
Awareness,
Technology Acceptance Model

ABSTRACT

This capstone project focuses on the development of a 2D animated short film designed to depict and raise awareness about HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. The animation aims to deliver a meaningful and narrative that highlights the experiences of individuals facing HIV stigma, emphasizing compassion, understanding, and the importance of breaking misconceptions. The project supports global advocacy efforts aligned with Sustainable Development Goal 3 (Good Health and Well-Being), Sustainable Development Goal 5 (Gender Equality), and Sustainable Development Goal 10 (Reduced Inequalities) by promoting inclusive attitudes, combating discrimination, and advocating for equal treatment for people living with HIV. The animation was evaluated using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), assessing respondents' Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, Attitude Toward Using, and Behavioral Intention. A total of 30 college students of Laguna State Polytechnic University Los Banos Campus participated in the film-viewing and survey evaluation. Results showed high acceptance across all categories, indicating a positive audience response. Findings demonstrate that the animated film effectively increased understanding of HIV stigma and fostered supportive attitudes toward individuals living with HIV. Additionally, results affirm that 2D animation is a powerful medium for health education and social awareness campaigns.

1. INTRODUCTION

According to the World Health Organization (2024), HIV remains a major global health issue, having claimed an estimated 42.3 million lives to date. Transmission continues in all countries worldwide. HIV (Human Immunodeficiency Virus) is a virus that attacks cells that help the body fight infection, making a person more vulnerable to other infections and diseases, it is spread by contact with certain bodily fluids of a person with HIV, most commonly during unprotected sex (sex without a condom or HIV medicine to prevent or treat HIV), or through sharing injection drug equipment (hiv.gov 2023).

The Philippines is currently facing the fastest-growing HIV epidemic in the Western Pacific region, with new HIV infections and AIDS-related deaths increasing by an alarming 418% and 535%, respectively, from 2010 to 2022. As of March 2024, the Department of Health (DOH) reported an average of 55 new HIV diagnoses per day. The agency also noted that among the 122,255 individuals living with HIV in the country, only 64%—or 78,633 people—are receiving antiretroviral therapy. According to projections, the estimated 189,000 people living with HIV (PLHIV) by the end of 2023 is expected to more than double, reaching approximately 401,700 by 2030 (Cordero Jr., Dalmacito A., National Library of Medicine).

Mrakovcic (2024) highlights that in the Philippines, societal perceptions of HIV significantly influence its transmission and treatment. Mrakovcic also stated that due to stigma and discrimination, the country is currently experiencing the fastest-growing HIV epidemic in the Western Pacific. Furthermore, stigma and discrimination extend beyond healthcare. People living with HIV (PLHIV) in the Philippines faced many challenges in employment, education, and social inclusion (UNAIDS, 2023). A 2021 study published by the International Labour Organization (ILO) found out that workplace discrimination and forced disclosure of HIV status remain prevalent in the country, discouraging individuals from seeking employment or disclosing their condition.

The Philippine government has enacted the RA 11166 which is the Philippine HIV and AIDS Policy Act that strengthens HIV prevention programs and promotes equal rights and address the growing HIV crisis in the Philippines. The International organizations such as UNAIDS and

WHO continue to advocate for awareness campaigns, expand the healthcare access, and anti-stigma initiatives to combat the HIV crisis epidemic effectively.

As HIV cases continue to rise in the Philippines, it is important to address the widespread misinformation and harmful stigmas surrounding the condition. This capstone project focuses on confronting these stigmas—particularly in Filipino communities—through a 2D animated video. By highlighting real-life inspired experiences and promoting accurate information, the project aims to bring attention to the social challenges faced by people living with HIV and emphasize the need for open, informed conversations about the issue.

Project Objectives

The primary goal of this project was to develop a 2D animated video addressing HIV-related stigma in the Filipino context. Specifically, the project aimed to:

1. Identify HIV-related stigma experienced by Filipinos, particularly through interview with individual living with HIV and from video documentaries;

2. Produce a two-dimensional animated video depicting Filipino HIV stigma;

3. Assess the video using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM).

RELATED LITERATURE

2D Animated

The evolution of animation techniques, particularly the transition from traditional 2D to 3D animation and the emergence of hybrid approaches combining both methods. While 2D animation offers classic aesthetic and simpler line work, it requires meticulous frame-by frame synchronization. Conversely, 3D animation provides flexibility but entails higher production costs and smaller team sizes. The authors discuss the challenges faced by hybrid animation, such as style matching, registration issues, and technical considerations like frame rate and timing (Luntraru, C., Asavei, V., Moldoveanu, A., & Moldoveanu, F. 2022). Explore the efficacy of incorporating 2D animation into undergraduate business management education. Their study reveals that 2D animation positively influences student learning outcomes, particularly when compared to traditional PowerPoint presentations. Through thematic analysis and participant observations, they underscore the advantages of using animated characters and emphasize the enhanced role of lecturers, especially in online teaching environments. The research highlights the potential of innovative teaching methods like 2D animation in fostering student engagement and preparing them for leadership roles in knowledge-driven economy (Qinran, Y. and Cao, W. 2021).

HIV Transmission and Control

Culturally, LGBTQIA+ individuals in the Philippines face stigma largely rooted in religious beliefs (Ruiz Austria, 2004). With religion playing a significant role in the lives of many Filipinos, this strong religiosity often contributes to negative perceptions of GBM (United States Agency for International Development [UNAIDS] & United Nations Development Program [UNDP], 2014). Since HIV is closely linked to sex and sexuality, Filipino GBM are frequently viewed as sinful within the cultural context (Canoy & Ofreneo, 2012). This belief is heavily shaped by the moral teachings of the Roman Catholic Church (Ruiz Austria, 2004). As Canoy and Ofreneo (2017) observed, Filipino GBM living with HIV who are in same-sex relationships often feel compelled to question their identities, as they navigate the conflict between their sexuality, their HIV status, and the religious framing of sin. In a society deeply influenced by conservative religious values, stigma can be deeply ingrained. This intersection of HIV-related and queer stigma is often linked to notions of “morality, dirtiness, and sin” (Adia et al., 2018, p. 322).

Forms of HIV Discrimination

HIV discrimination manifests in healthcare settings, workplaces, and educational institutions. In the healthcare sector, some patients with HIV report denial of treatment, breach of confidentiality, and judgmental attitudes from healthcare providers (WHO, 2023). Workplace discrimination also remains a problem, with employees losing jobs or facing workplace harassment after their HIV status is disclosed (ILO, 2022).

Psychological Impact of HIV Stigma

HIV stigma also leads to internalized stigma, where individuals develop shame, guilt, and fear of disclosure, resulting in mental health issues like anxiety and depression (Logie & Gadalla, 2020). Fear of discrimination discourages HIV testing and adherence to antiretroviral therapy (ART), increasing the risk of disease progression (Pulerwitz et al., 2021).

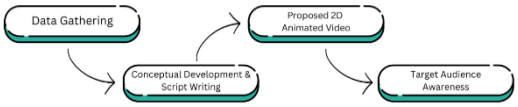
Efforts to Reduce HIV Stigma

Global organizations such as UNAIDS, WHO, and local government agencies have implemented awareness campaigns, policies, and laws to combat HIV stigma and discrimination. The Philippine HIV and AIDS Policy Act (RA 11166) was enacted to strengthen HIV prevention programs and ensure the rights of people living

with HIV (PLHIV) (DOH, 2023). Community-based initiatives and peer support programs have also been found effective in reducing stigma and improving health-seeking behaviors (Mabachi et al., 2022).

Conceptual Framework

The figure below presents the conceptual framework that guide the development of the proposed 2D animated video addressing HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. The process begins with identifying HIV-related stigma often experienced by Filipinos through interviews with individuals living with HIV and video documentaries online. This is followed by the conceptualization phase, which includes scriptwriting and planning for the 2D animated video that addresses the HIV stigma. The project's last phase focuses on the desired results of tackling stigma associated with HIV in the Philippines. Among these results is the promotion of more stigma-free and inclusive attitudes and behaviors in the community, especially among parents and young people. The capstone project seeks to establish a social setting where individuals feel valued and supported by drawing attention to the realities of stigma. The proposed 2D animated video project will be planned and carried out according to this framework, which will make sure



that it accurately reflects and addresses these objectives.

Figure 1. Conceptual Framework

3. METHODOLOGY

Project Design

This capstone project aims to address the stigma associated with HIV in the Filipino community, which continues to be a major obstacle to social inclusion, treatment, and testing. The project's goal is to illustrate the negative impacts of stigma and the social obstacles that people living with HIV (PLHIV) face by making a 2D animated short film. Stories based on actual events that represent the most prevalent HIV stigmas in the Philippines will be included in the animation. The primary goal is to illustrate these stigmas and promote contemplation regarding their influence on Filipino society.

Animation Development Model

To effectively depict the most prevalent HIV-related stigmas in the Philippines, this 2D animated video will be developed using a structured animation pipeline. Every stage of the procedure will help us to produce an impactful and accurate portrayal that appeals to the audience.



Figure 2. Animation Development Model

Research Design

The research methodology for this study was a purposive design. It aimed to describe the acceptance and impact of the developed 2D animation addressing HIV related stigma in the Philippines. The animation was created focusing on giving empathy to people living with HIV. The characters were designed to represent realistic Filipino experiences and emotions, shaping relatable personas that effectively convey the message of empathy and understanding. Through visual storytelling, the animation sought to influence viewers' perceptions, promote compassion toward people living with HIV.

Sampling technique

Table 3. Respondents of the study

Respondents	Number of Respondents
College Students	30
Total	30

Table 3 shows that participants for this study were selected from the target demographic of college students in LSPU Los Baños, using a purposive sampling technique. This sampling method allows for the intentional selection of individuals who possess characteristics relevant to the study's objectives. College students were chosen as respondents because they are at a developmental stage where awareness of social and health issues—such as HIV and the stigma surrounding it—is critical. Their level of maturity and understanding enables them to provide meaningful feedback on the 2D animated video, particularly regarding its effectiveness in educating, raising awareness, and reducing stigma related to HIV in the Philippine context. A total of 30 college students participated in the study.

Population of the study

The population of this study consists of college students who can understand and evaluate social and health-related issues, particularly those concerning HIV awareness and stigma. These participants were chosen because they represent a group that can critically reflect on societal attitudes and behaviors toward people living with HIV. Insights from this population are valuable in assessing the effectiveness of the 2D animated video in promoting accurate information, empathy, and stigma reduction.

Data Collection Instrument

A closed-ended questionnaire was utilized as the primary data collection instrument for this study. The questionnaire was designed to assess the audience's awareness, perception, and attitudes toward HIV and HIV-related stigma after viewing the 2D animated short film *"More Than HIV."* Respondents completed the questionnaire within approximately 15 to 20 minutes after viewing the short film. The collected responses were then analyzed and interpreted to determine the effectiveness of the animated video in promoting empathy and reducing misconceptions about HIV within the target audience.

Table 4. Likert Scale

Rating	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
5	Strongly agree
4	Agree
3	Neutral
2	Disagree
1	Strongly Disagree

A standardized questionnaire was adopted for the purpose, which assessed the efficacy of the 2D animated short film "More Than HIV" based on key criteria: Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, Attitude Towards Using, and Behavioral Intention, using the Technology Acceptance Model. These criteria have been used to evaluate a variety of ways in which the respondents perceive the said animation regarding its educational value, clarity of message, and overall impact it creates on the respondents' awareness and understanding of HIV-related stigma.

Data

Data for this study were obtained through several video documentaries regarding HIV stigma in the Philippines and through interview among PLHIV. These provided valuable insights into real-life experiences of stigma, discrimination, and misunderstanding that people with HIV face. From the information collated, some of the common themes that emerged included educational stigma, workplace discrimination, community judgment, and self-stigma, on which the narrative of the short film was founded.

The data led the way in developing the characters and storyline of the 2D animated short "More Than HIV." Through the incorporation of actual experiences and observations from the documentaries and interviews, the animation hopes to bring a sensitive and realistic portrayal of people living with HIV. And this, in a way, can be an assurance that the film will be able to create awareness and authentically represent the emotional and social burdens posed by stigma on Filipino society.

Statistical Instrument of Data

Descriptive statistics were used in this study to summarize the data, calculating the Mean (M) and Standard Deviation (SD), which were recorded in an MS Excel spreadsheet. IBM SPSS software was then employed to interpret the overall results, allowing for a thorough analysis of the data. This approach helped identify key trends and ensured the findings were statistically reliable, validating the effectiveness of the 2D animated video in achieving its educational goals.

Technology Acceptance Model

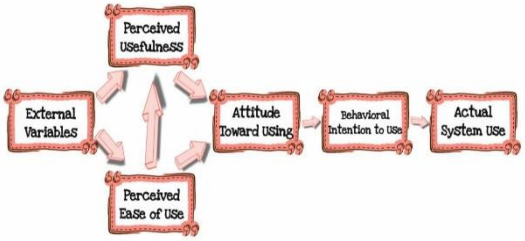


Figure 3. Technology Acceptance Model

The Technology Acceptance Model is an information systems theory that describes how individuals accept and use new technologies. It forms a useful basis for finding out why users may decide to use or not use a certain medium, including educational 2D animated films. While TAM does not involve data collection per se, it provides an effective theoretical model for analyzing how viewers respond to innovations in educational communication, such as animation for advocacy and awareness campaigns.

In the case of this research, TAM was applied to investigate the audience's acceptance of the 2D animated short film "More Than HIV." The model centers on four important constructs: Perceived Usefulness, Perceived Ease of Use, Attitude Toward Using, and Behavioral Intention. These will determine whether the viewers found the animation educational, easy to understand, and engaging, especially in promulgating more awareness about HIV stigma in the Philippines. The principles of TAM can be used as the basis for acquiring relevant feedback to ensure that the short film is clear, relevant, and effective in encouraging empathy and reducing discrimination against people living with HIV.

Table 5. Reliability test result for Technology Acceptance Model

Categories	Cronbach Alpha's	Verbal Interpretation
Perceived of Usefulness	.962	Excellent
Perceived Ease of Use	.860	Good
Attitude Toward Using	.917	Excellent

Behavioral Intention	.900	Excellent
Composite Score	.910	Excellent

Legend: above .90 = Excellent, 0.80-0.89 = Good, 0.70-0.79 = Acceptable, 0.60-0.69 = Questionable, 0.50-0.59 = Poor, below 0.50 = Unacceptable

Table 5 shows the reliability test results using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM). The internal consistency for all categories was highly reliable. In fact, all categories received ratings ranging from "Good" to "Excellent." In other words, all the evaluation criteria were highly reliable to measure the perception and response of the audience. Moreover, the Composite Score .910 earned an "Excellent" rating, indicating that in general, the TAM model is highly reliable in this study.

This suggests that TAM is reliable and valid for testing the factors related to the audience's acceptance of the 2D animated short film "More Than HIV." The congruence across categories indicates that the instrument appropriately measured the perceived usefulness, clarity, and emotional impact of the animation by the viewers. Thus, TAM was an appropriate and valid tool in determining how the audience engaged and understood the digital animation of HIV stigma awareness.

4. RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

This chapter presents the results of the study and analyzes the findings in the context of the main objective of the project, interpreting them using the principles and components of the Technology Acceptance Model.

Results by Objectives

Main Objectives

The main objective of this study is to develop a 2D animated video depicting HIV related stigma in the Philippines. This objective was achieved by thorough investigation, effort, as well as the equipment required to produce the video.

1. **Discuss key information about HIV stigma in the Philippines that needs to be included in the 2D animated video.**

Character Creation: Based on insights gathered from interviews and video documentaries online about HIV stigma in the Philippines, it was found that misconceptions, discrimination, and self-stigma remain major barriers to understanding HIV. These findings guided the creation of the main character and supporting roles in the 2D animated short film *"More Than HIV."*

2. **Develop a character based on the data gathered and the script.**

The characters were created using Photoshop for various tools. It is widely used for character creation and digital designs.



Figure 4. Mark Dela Cruz

Figure 4: Mark's character is a poignant representation of the stigma placed on individuals as a result of educational, workplace, and community factors. His journey speaks where discrimination has silenced the voices; he stands strong-a character of strength, oozing humanity, with dignity beyond an HIV status.



Figure 5. Classmates

Figure 5 shows Mark's classmates, the supporting characters in the short film "More Than HIV." They epitomize the function of educational stigma in the story, showing how informed prejudice and misinformed judgments may come into play even in everyday academic settings. Both are designed as typical college students-a young woman and a young man-wearing casual university attire to symbolize the ordinary setting where discrimination often occurs unnoticed.



Figure 6. Manager

Figure 6 presents the Manager; he is a supporting character in the short film "More Than HIV," where he characterizes stigma in the workplace for the person living with HIV. He is essential in showing how discrimination can take place in people's workplaces, too. The character of the Manager is an average middle-aged man dressed in a simple polo shirt and apron; he symbolizes his status in a small restaurant setting and maintains a very realistic character design.



Figure 7. Neighbors

Figure 7 presents two characters, Mark's neighbors—a middle-aged woman and an elderly man—both of whom typify community stigma in the short film "More Than HIV." Both characters symbolize the extent to which prejudice and discrimination against people living with HIV could even become part of the local environment and social exchange. Their design and behavior are elaborated by how misinformation, gossip, and moral judgment can play a role in the isolation and emotional distress of those affected.



Figure 8. Support Group Member

Figure 8: Introduction of a young lady from the HIV support group who is a major supporting character in the short film “More Than HIV.” She represents hope, understanding, and acceptance of the community in choosing compassion over judgment. This character plays an important role in the road to emotional healing and acceptance of Mark after he experiences several forms of stigma.

3. Evaluate the 2D animated video using Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 6. Perceived Usefulness (PU) based on the Respondents' Response

STATEMENTS	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRETATION
The short film increased my understanding of HIV-related stigma.	4.6	0.63	Strongly Agree
The story helped me realize how stigma affects people living with HIV.	4.6	0.62	Strongly Agree
The information presented in the film is useful for HIV stigma awareness.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
The film can be used as an educational material for awareness campaigns.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
COMPOCITE MEAN	**4.5**	**0.63**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend: 1= Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Agree, 4 = Strongly Agree

Table 6 shows the respondents' level of agreement on the Perceived

Table 6 shows the perceived usefulness of the 2D animated video as rated by the respondents. With a composite mean of 4.5 and a standard deviation of 0.63, interpreted as “Strongly Agree,” the results of this study indicate that the video was very effective in creating awareness and understanding of HIV-related stigma. The respondents strongly agreed that by watching this film, they were able to realize how stigma affects the lives of people living with HIV, and the information presented in the animation could be very useful for awareness purposes. Moreover, the short film is considered an excellent educational material worthy of being used in advocacy and awareness drives. This thus confirms that the purpose of the 2D animated video—to educate viewers more about HIV stigma, appreciate their empathetic concerns, and further understand the issue—was very well served.

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 7. Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU) based on the Respondents Response

STATEMENT	MEAN	SD	VERBAL INTERPRATION
The story was easy to understand and follow.	4.6	0.55	Strongly Agree
The visuals and animations helped me understand the message better.	4.6	0.62	Strongly Agree
The dialogues were clear.	4.5	0.51	Strongly Agree
The pacing of the scenes made it comfortable to watch.	4.6	0.50	Strongly Agree
COMPOSITE MEAN	**4.6**	**0.55**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend 1 = Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Agree, 4 = Strongly Agree

Table 7 shows the extent of the respondents' agreement regarding the Perceived Ease of Use of the 2D animated video. With a composite mean of 4.6 and a standard deviation of 0.55, interpreted as "Strongly Agree," the results showed that the video was clear, interesting, and easy to follow. The responses strongly agreed that the story was simple to understand, the images and animations supported the message well, and the dialogues were clear and moderately paced. The comfortable pacing of the scenes further contributed to a positive viewing experience. These results confirm that the design of the video was structured in such a way that the flow of the visuals and the content provided no obstacle to comprehension, while maintaining viewer interest. Overall, the results confirm that the 2D animated video was user-friendly and appropriately drafted for communicating its message on HIV stigma awareness effectively.

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 8. Attitude Toward Using (ATU) based on the Respondent's Response

STATEMENT	**MEAN**	**SD**	**VERBAL INTERPRATION**
I enjoyed watching the short film.	4.5	0.63	Strongly Agree
The short film made me feel more empathetic toward people with HIV.	4.5	0.68	Strongly Agree
I believe the film presents HIV Pinoy stigma in a respectful and human way.	4.6	0.56	Strongly Agree
The film motivated me to think about how I view people with HIV.	4.5	0.62	Strongly Agree
COMPOSITE MEAN	**4.5**	**0.63**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend1= Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Agree, 4 = Strongly Agree

Table 8 shows the respondents' level of agreement in response to statements that highlight their Attitude Toward Using (ATU) the 2D animated video. With a composite mean of 4.5 and a standard deviation of 0.63, interpreted as "Strongly Agree," the results show that viewers developed a very positive attitude toward the short film. The respondents strongly agreed that they liked watching the video and had become more understanding of people living with HIV after watching the video. They also felt that the video depicted HIV-related stigma in the Philippines in a respectful and humane manner. What's more, the video made them contemplate their own judgments about people with HIV. This suggests that the 2D animated film was both emotionally engaging and informative, facilitated empathy, and raised awareness—a confirmation that this film is indeed a potent tool for enhancing understanding while reducing stigma about HIV.

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE

Table 9. Behavioral Intention (BI) based on the Respondents' Response

STATEMENT	**MEAN**	**SD**	**VERBAL INTERPRATATION**
I am more likely to support HIV awareness after watching the film.	4.4	0.93	Strongly Agree
I will recommend this short film to others.	4.5	0.82	Strongly Agree
The film encouraged me to be more understanding toward people living with HIV.	4.4	0.90	Strongly Agree
COMPOSITE MEAN	**4.4**	**0.88**	**Strongly Agree**

Legend: 1=Strongly Disagree, 2 = Disagree, 3 = Agree, 4 = Strongly Agree

Table 9 shows the level of agreement by the respondents in terms of their Behavioral Intention with respect to viewing the 2D animated video. In fact, with a composite mean of 4.4 and a standard deviation of 0.88, interpreted as "Strongly Agree," the respondents believe that the video had a great influence on enhancing viewers' behavioral intentions. The statements to which the respondents strongly agreed include: they are more willing to support HIV awareness, and that they can recommend the short film to others after watching it. They also agreed that the video encouraged them to be more understanding and

compassionate toward people living with HIV. These prove that the 2D animated video successfully influences viewers to think and act positively—to create awareness and show empathy—which further proves that this is another successful educational and advocacy tool against HIV stigma.

5. SUMMARY, CONCLUSIONS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

This chapter summarizes the study's objectives, methods, development, testing, and results. It also highlights the key findings and provides recommendations to further improve the project's effectiveness and success.

Summary of Findings

The project centers on creating a 2D animated film in a way that will increase awareness of HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. It aligns with SDG 3: Good Health and Well-Being, SDG 5: Gender Equality, and SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities, which highlight access to health information, equality, and protection against discrimination for all. The animation tackles the emotional, social, and psychological impact of stigma faced by people living with HIV while fostering empathy, understanding, and acceptance in society. The goal of this 2D animation project is to showcase stories inspired by real-life experiences that depict various forms of HIV stigma, emphasizing compassion and reduction of stigma. The film aims to encourage viewers, particularly college students—to reflect on their perceptions and develop greater respect, inclusivity, and support for people living with HIV.

The project moved through different stages to keep the story clear and real. Info came from HIV stigma documentaries in the Philippines, and interview with people who've faced stigma around HIV. From what we found, a solid script plus visuals were mapped out. The animation got built with digital drawing tools or programs made for motion art, while voice performers followed a set script, so characters felt alive. Audio bits - like mood music or small sound details - were mixed in through a focus on feeling, making the whole thing hit harder.

To check how well the project worked, researchers applied the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), focusing on how useful people found it, how easy they thought it was to use, their overall feelings about it, along with their willingness to use it again. Thirty participants took part in a survey that collected opinions about the 2D Animation's clearness, learning benefits, ability to hold attention, as well as its effect on emotions.

The findings showed people welcomed it well, plus reactions were clearly favorable - proof the 2D Animation effectively boosted insight about HIV stigma. Most audience members felt sure it expanded their grasp of the topic while shifting how they see things, also pushing them to stand by those affected by HIV. The results suggest the initiative successfully brought together straightforward narratives, heartfelt emotion, OR educational value to meet its aim - lessening stigma while encouraging empathy. Good feedback highlights how 2D animation can serve as an impactful way to teach, drive change, or boost public understanding.

Conclusion

This study successfully developed, tested, and evaluated the 2D animated video titled *"More Than HIV"*, which aims to raise awareness and reduce HIV-related stigma in the Philippines. The animation underwent a structured process including research, gathering data from video documentaries and through interview with people living with HIV, scriptwriting, character design development, and storyboard creation to ensure accurate representation of HIV issues and socially relevant narratives.

To assess the 2D Animation effectiveness, the final animation was evaluated by 30 college students. Feedback highlighted the video's success in common misconceptions, and portraying stigma-related experiences with sensitivity. Respondents emphasized its emotional impact and clarity in presenting the realities faced by individuals affected by HIV. Using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM), the project obtained an overall acceptance rating of 4.5, indicating that the video is useful, understandable, and engaging for general audiences.

1. Identify key information on HIV stigma to include in the animation

Essential information about HIV stigma, and common misconceptions was gathered through interview with people living with HIV (PLHIV) and analysis of 21 video documentaries on HIV stigma in the Philippines. These firsthand accounts and real-world narratives provided authentic insights into lived experiences, discrimination challenges, and emotional impacts, ensuring that the storyline and messaging were grounded in real-life Filipino contexts and voices.

2. Develop characters and narrative based on gathered data

Characters and storyline elements were conceptualized based on the gathered insights, representing common stigma scenarios faced by PLHIV in the Philippines. Digital illustrations using Adobe Photoshop reflected diverse

backgrounds and emotional expressions, while the script and storyboard were created to depict realistic experiences and lessons promoting empathy and understanding.

3. Evaluate the 2D animated video using the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)

The survey, created with expert consultation, collected feedback from 30 college student in LSPU Los Baños respondents. The 2D animated short film received an overall TAM acceptance score of 4.5, indicating that the video is effective in enhancing awareness, reshaping perceptions, and encouraging acceptance and compassion toward people living with HIV.

Recommendations

Based on the findings, evaluation results, and feedback gathered from respondents, the following recommendations are proposed to strengthen the impact, reach, and future development of the 2D animated video addressing HIV stigma in the Philippines:

1. Utilize the animated video as educational material in health-related courses, community outreach programs, and seminars focused on HIV awareness, stigma reduction, and sexual health education.

2. Collaborate with local health units, NGOs, and advocacy groups such as DOH, LoveYourself PH, and community-based organizations to integrate the video into their HIV information campaigns and counselling sessions.

3. Conduct further studies using a larger and more diverse sample size to better evaluate the video's effectiveness across different demographics—including youth, adults, and community workers.

4. Enhance future production with improved audio, character animation, and visual storytelling, using programs such as Toon Boom, Adobe Animate, Blendr (for 2D/2.5D integration), and professional sound design tools.

5. Develop additional animated episodes or sequels focusing on broader HIV topics such as prevention methods, treatment (ART), U=U (Undetectable = Untransmittable), myths and facts, and lived experiences of people living with HIV.

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APPENDIX

H

SURVEY QUESTIONNAIRE

Audience Acceptance of the 2D Animated Short Film “More Than HIV” Based on the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM)

This survey aims to evaluate the audience’s acceptance of the 2D animated short film “More Than HIV” based on the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM).

Your responses will help assess the film’s effectiveness in promoting HIV awareness and reducing stigma.

All responses will be kept confidential and used for academic purposes only.

* Indicates required question

1. Age: *

2. Gender: *

   Mark only one oval.

   - ◯ Male
   - ◯ Female
   - ◯ Prefer not to say

3. Year Level: *

4. Have you previously watched any HIV awareness content? *

Mark only one oval.

- Yes
- No

🎬 Watch “More Than HIV” Before Answering

Please watch the short 2D animated film below before proceeding to the next section. Your feedback will help us evaluate the film’s effectiveness in promoting HIV awareness and reducing stigma.

💡 Keywords to Guide You While Watching:
HIV – A virus that attacks the immune system but can be managed with proper treatment.
Stigma – Negative judgment or discrimination toward people with HIV.
Acceptance – Respecting and supporting people living with HIV without prejudice.
Empathy – Understanding and sharing the feelings of others.

🩸 How HIV Spreads:
HIV can spread through the exchange of certain body fluids such as blood, semen, vaginal fluids, rectal fluids, and breast milk — usually during unprotected sex, sharing needles, or from mother to child during birth or breastfeeding.

Watch “More Than HIV” Before Proceeding



http://youtube.com/watch?v=ME3MZDGsgXE

Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) Constructs

Instruction: Please rate your level of agreement with the following statements about the short film “More Than HIV”, using the scale below:

5 – Strongly Agree
4 – Agree
3 – Neutral
2 – Disagree
1 – Strongly Disagree

5. **A. Perceived Usefulness (PU)** *
(How helpful or educational the film is)

Mark only one oval per row.

	1 – Strongly Disagree	2 – Disagree	3 – Neutral	4 – Agree	5 – Strongly Agree
The short film increased my understanding of HIV-related stigma.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The story helped me realize how stigma affects people living with HIV.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The information presented in the film is useful for HIV stigma awareness.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The film can be used as an educational material for awareness campaigns.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

6. **B. Perceived Ease of Use (PEOU)** *
(How easy the film is to understand and follow)

Mark only one oval per row.

	1 – Strongly Disagree	2 – Disagree	3 – Neutral	4 – Agree	5 – Strongly Agree
The story was easy to understand and follow.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The visuals and animations helped me understand the message better.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The dialogues were clear.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The pacing of the scenes made it comfortable to watch.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

7. **C. Attitude Toward Using (ATU)** *
(How the viewer feels about the film and its message)

Mark only one oval per row.

	1 – Strongly Disagree	2 – Disagree	3 – Neutral	4 – Agree	5 – Strongly Agree
I enjoyed watching the short film.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The short film made me feel more empathetic toward people with HIV.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
I believe the film presents HIV Pinoy stigma in a respectful and human way.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The film motivated me to think about how I view people with HIV.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

8. **D. Behavioral Intention (BI)** *
(Whether the film influences future behavior or awareness)

Mark only one oval per row.

	1 – Strongly Disagree	2 – Disagree	3 – Neutral	4 – Agree	5 – Strongly Agree
I am more likely to support HIV awareness after watching the film.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
I will recommend this short film to others.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯
The film encouraged me to be more understanding toward people living with HIV.	◯	◯	◯	◯	◯

Open-Ended Questions (Optional)

9. 1. What part of the film impacted you the most?

10. 2. What can be improved in the short film?

End Note:

Thank you for taking the time to participate in this survey.

Your feedback will help evaluate the effectiveness of *"More Than HIV"* in promoting HIV awareness and reducing stigma.

This content is neither created nor endorsed by Google.

Google Forms

APPENDIX

I

SIMILARITY REPORT

14% Overall Similarity

The combined total of all matches, including overlapping sources, for each database.

Match Groups

- **90** Not Cited or Quoted 11%
  Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks
- **17** Missing Quotations 3%
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Top Sources

11% Internet sources
7% Publications
9% Submitted works (Student Papers)

Top Sources

The sources with the highest number of matches within the submission. Overlapping sources will not be displayed.

1	Publication	Aron Harold G. Pamoso, Brett Scholz, Austin Ferolino. ""Because of HIV, It Opened... 2%
2	Student papers	Laguna State Polytechnic University 1%
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APPENDIX

J

GRAMMAR REPORT

More Than HIV: Pinoy Stigma in 2D Animation

by Ronah joy Ramirez

General metrics

81,028	11,507	982	46 min 1 sec	1 hr 28 min
characters	words	sentences	reading time	speaking time

Score



This text scores better than 93% of all texts checked by Grammarly

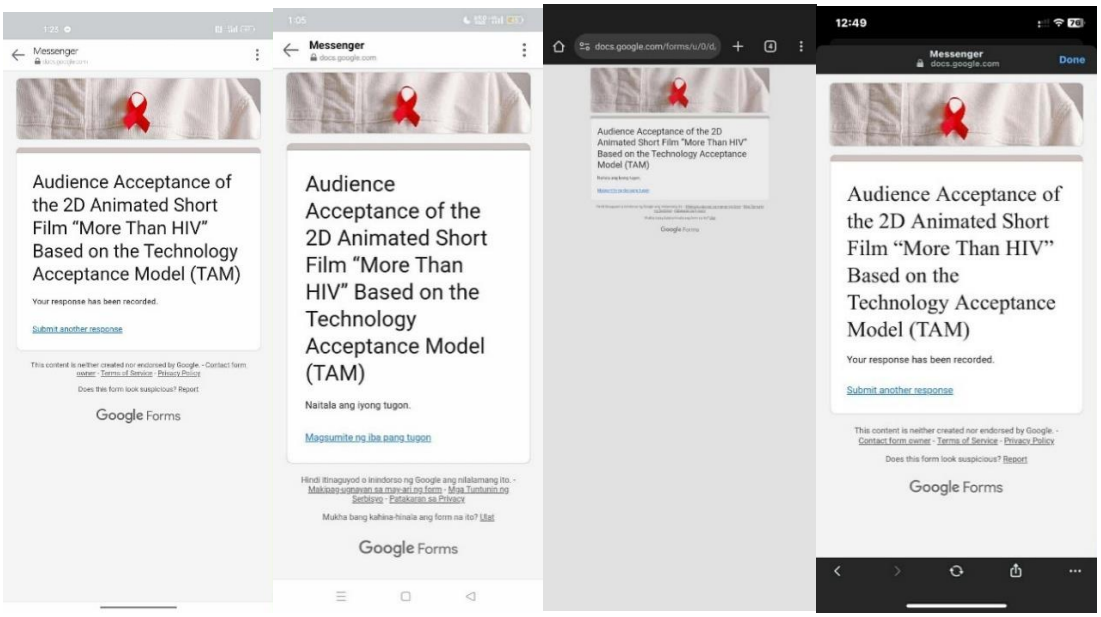
Writing Issues

223	82	141
Issues left	Critical	Advanced

APPENDIX

K

LEVEL OF ACCEPTANCE



Here are some google forms screenshot of college students who participated in our survey.

APPENDIX

L

STUDENT CURICULLUM VITAE

AXEL BOLIMA

GRAPHIC DESIGN



About Me

I am a creative multimedia designer skilled in graphic design, 2D animation, and visual storytelling. I create meaningful and engaging content with a strong focus on concept, detail, and impact. I am hardworking, adaptable, and always eager to grow and contribute my skills to a creative team.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology Specialized in Animation and Motion Graphics

Laguna State Polytechnic University

2022- 2026

Experience

Capstone Project

- Created a 2D animated short focused on HIV awareness and stigma.
- Designed characters, backgrounds, and visual storytelling assets.
- Applied animation principles and visual communication techniques.
- Used animation to educate and promote social awareness.

Freelance Graphic Designer

- Designed logos, social media posts, and posters for small projects.
- Edited videos and motion graphics for online content.
- Practiced branding and layout design for different styles.

Skill

Photo editing ★★★★½

Web layout design ★★★★★

Animation ★★★½☆

CONTACT

09511394305

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Los Baños, Laguna



ALJON M. LIBRANZA

09759681937

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B45 L18 Kapayapaan Ville Canlubang
Calamba City, Laguna 4028

EDUCATION

Laguna State Polytechnic University

Bachelor of Science in Information and Techonology

2022-2026

Kapayapaan Integrated School

Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics

2021-2022

Kapayapaan Integrated School

Junior Highschool

2017-2021

SKILLS

- Multi-tasking
- Time Management
- Adaptability
- Communication
- Work Ethic

LANGUAGE

English

Tagalog

About Me

Motivated and detail-oriented individual seeking a position where I can apply my skills, education, and passion for continuous learning to contribute effectively to the goals of the organization, while gaining professional experience and personal growth.

WORK EXPERIENCE

MARCH 2021- PRESENT

Service Crew

Mr. Customer Delight

- Provide excellent customer service ensuring customer satisfaction.
- Collaborated with team members to ensure smooth daily operations.

PERSONAL DETAILS

Civil Status: Single

Birthdate: July 28,2004

Birthplace: Sta cruz Manila

Nationality: Filipino

Religion: Catholic

REFERENCES

Jessa Villamayor

Customer Service Representative

Phone: 09764339873



Louisse Anne V. Torres

21 / Female

Palis St. Timugan Los Baños, Laguna

Louissetorres14@gmail.com

09653073608

PERSONAL INFORMATION

- **Civil Status:** Single
- **Birthdate:** May 18, 2004
- **Birthplace:** Quezon, Tayabas City
- **Father:** Lucio Q. Torres
- **Mother:** Agnes P. Valderamos

SKILLS

- Communication Skills
- Time Management Skills
- Drawing
- Teamwork and Collaboration

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

Elementary: **Bernardo N. Calara**

Graduated 2016

Junior High School: **Poblacion National High School**

Graduated 2020

Senior High School: **Colegio De Los Baños**

Humanities and Social Sciences

Graduated 2022

College: **Laguna State Polytechnic University**

(Los Baños Campus)

ID No. 0422-0945



JHON PAUL O. MAGASO

PROFILE

I am a motivated and reliable individual with a strong work ethic and a willingness to learn. I adapt quickly to new environments and enjoy working both independently and in a team. I am committed to delivering quality work and continuously improving my skills.

SKILLS

- Adobe Photoshop
- Communication
- Time Management
- Teamwork Collaboration

LANGUAGE

- ENGLISH
- FILIPINO

PERSONAL DETAILS

- Birthdate : June 04 2001
- Birthplace : JP Rizal Calamba City
- Civil Status : Single
- Nationality : Filipino
- Religion : Roman Catholic

EDUCATIONAL HISTORY

LAGUNA STATE POLYTECHNIQUE UNUVERSITY - LOS BAÑOS
Bachelor of Science in Information Technology

LOS BAÑOS BAYOG SENIOR HIGHSCHOOL
Technical-Vocational-Livelihood

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